



REVELSTOKE.
CHAMBER OF COMMERCE
EST. 1895



CHILDCARE NEEDS ASSESSMENT

2026 CHILDCARE NEEDS ASSESSMENT SURVEY
FINDINGS FOR REVELSTOKE & CSRD AREA B

CNA

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SECTION 1.0

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A SNAPSHOT OF THE SITUATION.

Revelstoke's childcare system provides high-quality care when accessed but demand far exceeds available spaces, particularly for children under age 3. This gap is directly impacting families, workforce participation, and the local economy.

What we heard:

71
PERCENT

Workforce

Impacted workforce participation (n=182)

24
MONTH

Waitlists

Typical duration 12-24 months (n=72)

\$35
THOUSAND

Income Loss

Reported by families (annually)

49
PERCENT

Parent Care

Families relying on parental care (n=157)

60
PERCENT

Would change

Would change care if they could (n=130)

Key priorities & suggested actions:

Childcare spaces needed → **Expand Capacity** (especially 0-3)
Lower costs & subsidized care → **Improve Affordability**
Minimal to no flexible care options → **Expand flexibility**
Transparent waitlists → **Implement Centralized Waitlist System**

If no action is taken:

Workforce may decline
Labour shortage likely to increase
Families may leave
Economic growth constraints

What this means: Childcare is a household, workforce, and economic issue.

Parents unable to return to work



Reduced household income & spending



Workforce shortages & hiring challenges



Constrained community growth

The bottom line:

Revelstoke has strong childcare quality, but without increased capacity, access, & coordination, the system will continue to fall short. **Coordinated action is required to support families, strengthen the workforce, & sustain community growth.**

Based on responses from 246 households. Response counts vary by question (n=RESPONSES)

SECTION 2.0

RESEARCH APPROACH & METHODOLOGY

How this work was built.

This section outlines the approach used to collect, analyze, and interpret data for the Child Care Needs Assessment. The methodology builds on previous work completed through the Business Retention and Expansion (BRE) initiative and reflects a commitment to evidence-based, community-informed planning in Revelstoke.

Findings are based on responses from 246 households and reflect community experiences across a range of childcare needs.

2.1 Research Considerations

This assessment was developed in response to key themes identified through the 2025 BRE survey, where workforce participation, labour shortages, and cost of living, including access to childcare, were consistently identified as critical challenges.

Recognizing the direct connection between childcare availability and economic resilience, the survey questions were adapted from a template developed for North Vancouver's Child Care Action Plan by SPARC BC and project partners, with local additions to better understand Revelstoke-specific gaps, barriers, and community priorities.

As with all community-based research, findings are based on self-reported experiences and reflect conditions during the data collection period. While results provide strong directional insights, they should be interpreted as representative of broader community trends rather than exhaustive of all households.

2.2 The Childcare Needs Assessment Survey

The survey was designed to capture both quantitative and qualitative insights into childcare access, availability, affordability, and quality. Questions were structured to reflect the childcare journey and included:

- household and employment context
- current childcare arrangements
- waitlists and barriers to access
- satisfaction and lived experience
- preferences and priorities
- financial impacts and community feedback

A combination of multiple-choice, ranking, and open-ended questions was used to ensure both measurable data and detailed lived experiences were captured.

2.3 The Data Set

A total of 246 respondents completed the childcare survey, representing households with a range of children's ages, employment situations, and childcare needs.

Because families may have more than one child, some results reflect the number of children rather than respondents, and totals may exceed the number of households.

The responses include; both families currently using childcare, and those actively seeking care, providing a comprehensive view of demand, access challenges, and system gaps.

2.4 Data Collection

Data collection took place over approximately 6 weeks and involved a broad community outreach approach to ensure strong participation and representation. Engagement methods included:

- digital outreach through newsletters and social media channels
- presentations and community conversations, including Chamber events
- direct outreach through local organizations and key partners

- print materials distributed throughout the community

This multi-channel approach was designed to reduce barriers to participation and ensure that a diverse range of households could contribute their experiences.

2.5 Data Input, Analysis and Reporting

Survey responses were compiled and analyzed using descriptive statistics and presented through charts, tables, and summary figures throughout this report.

Qualitative responses were grouped into common themes to reflect shared experiences across respondents. Open-ended responses were lightly edited for clarity while preserving meaning, and identifying information was removed to maintain confidentiality.

Together, these methods provide both a high-level overview of trends and deeper insight into the lived experiences of families in Revelstoke.

SECTION 3.0

RESEARCH FINDINGS

What we heard from the community.

This section presents the results of the Child Care Needs Assessment, highlighting key trends, experiences, and priorities identified by respondents. Findings are organized to provide a clear understanding of childcare access, use, and impacts on families, informing the need for coordinated, community-based solutions.

The following findings reflect both quantitative data and lived experiences shared by families in Revelstoke.

SECTION 3.1

RESPONDENT PROFILE & HOUSEHOLD CONTEXT

Who this affects.

This section describes the households represented in the survey, including parent and guardian status, connection to Revelstoke, and household composition. It provides context for understanding who is experiencing childcare challenges in the community. ***Understanding who is affected helps frame the scale and scope of need.***

Section Snapshot

83%

PARENTS

respondents with
children aged 0–12

98%

LIVE LOCAL

live, work, or study in
Revelstoke

59%

UNDER AGE 3

households with
young children

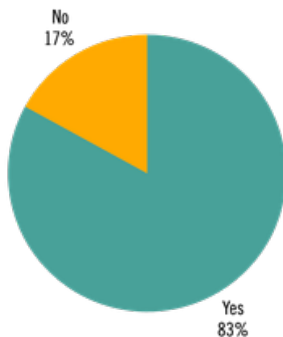
Key Findings

- Most respondents are established, long-term residents
- Households are primarily dual-adult and working
- High concentration of children under age 3

Findings reflect responses from families across Revelstoke; response counts vary by question.

Q1: Are you a parent or guardian with children ages 0 to 12 at home?

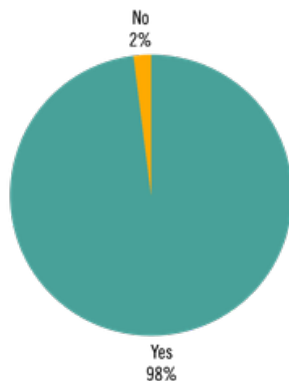
Answered: 246 Skipped: 1



A strong majority of respondents are parents or guardians of children aged 0-12, indicating that survey results are primarily informed by families currently navigating childcare needs.

Q2: Do you or your spouse either live, work or study in Revelstoke?

Answered: 204 Skipped: 43



Nearly all respondents have a direct connection to Revelstoke through living, working, or studying in the community, which reflects local childcare experiences and conditions.

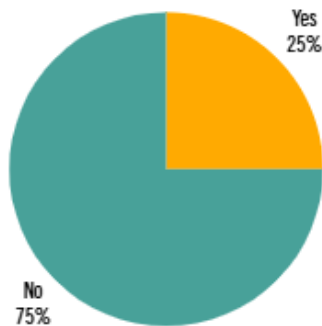


I work part-time, I study remotely, and I am a casual on-call EA.



Q3: Are you looking at relocating to Revelstoke?

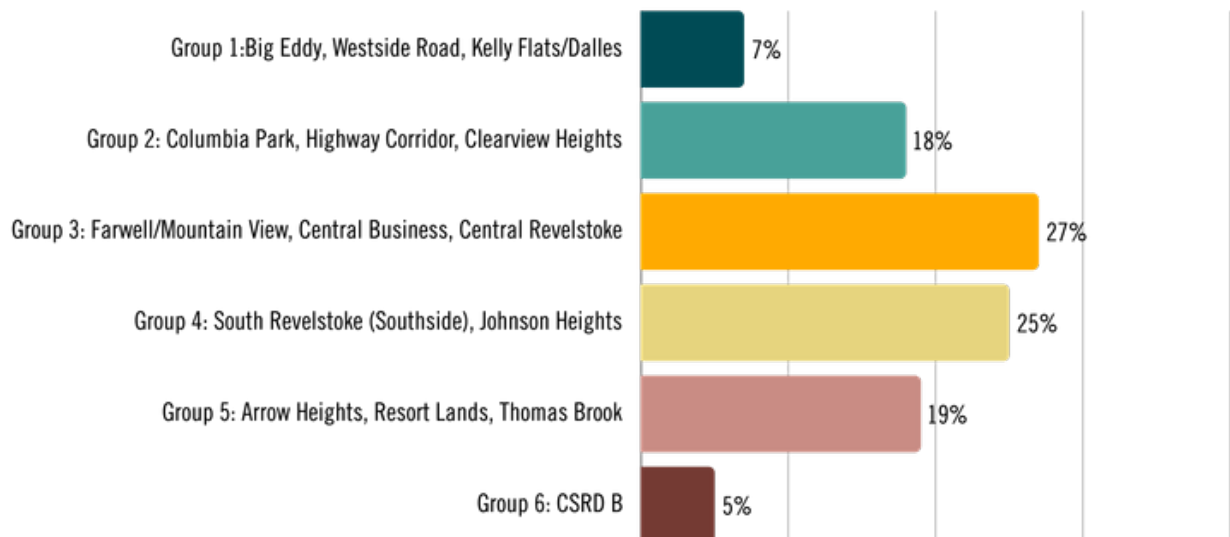
Answered: 4 Skipped: 243



Very few respondents answered this question, and results should be interpreted as such. Among those who did respond, most are not planning to relocate.

Q4: Where do you live? (City of Revelstoke Neighbourhood Groups)

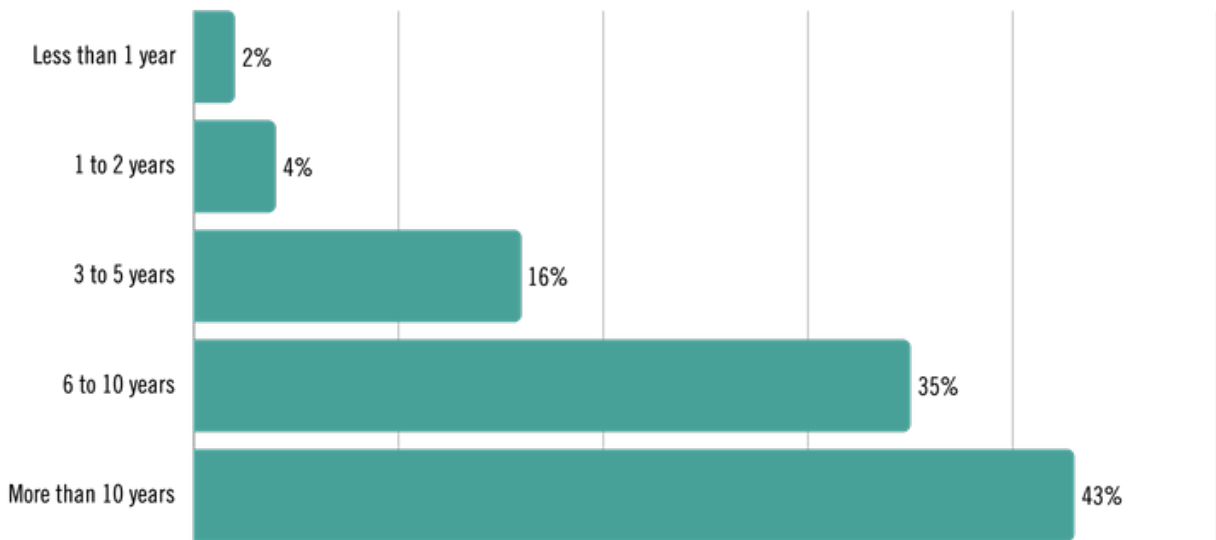
Answered: 199 Skipped: 48



Q5: How many years have you lived in Revelstoke?

The majority of respondents are long-term residents, with over three-quarters having lived in Revelstoke for more than five years, suggesting a deep familiarity with the community and its childcare challenges.

Answered: 199 Skipped: 48

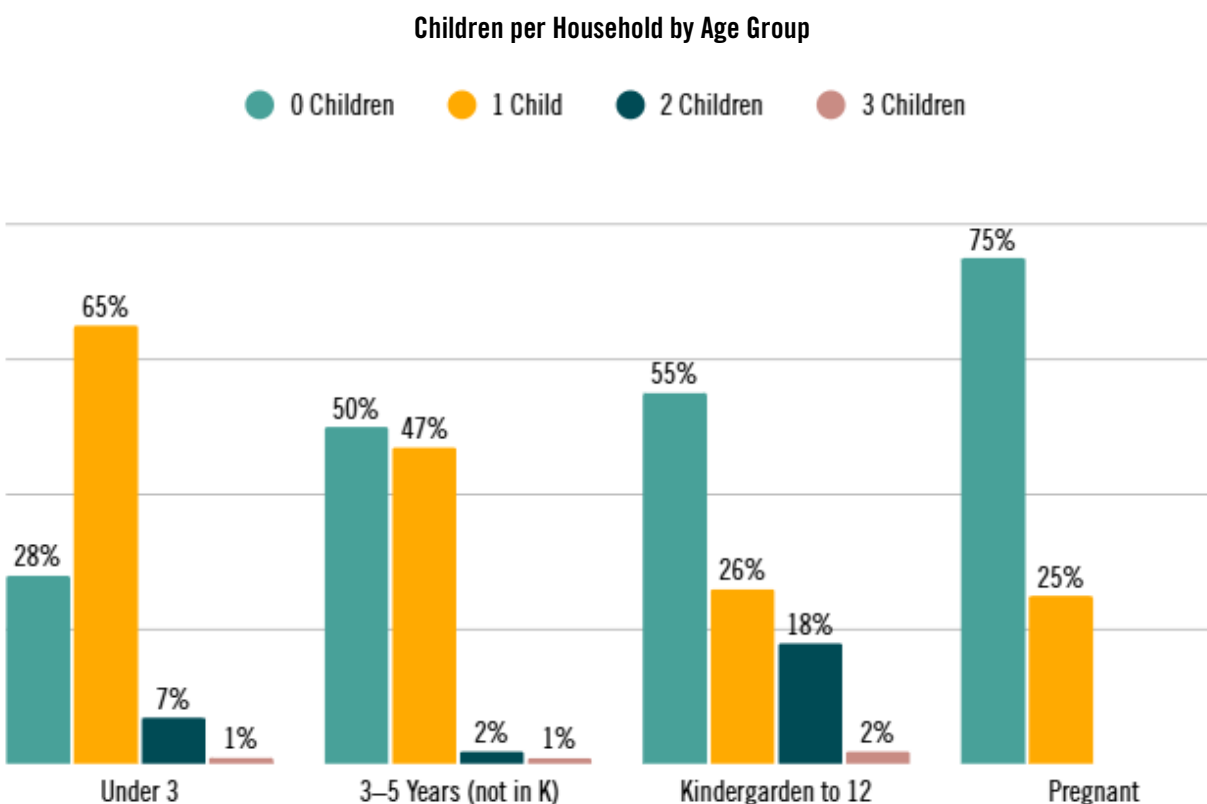


“ I would love to return full-time to my career and have my child in a centre that encourages creative learning, outdoor-based play, etc. to help them develop. I need to work in order to afford my mortgage. ”

Q6: How many children living with you are in each age group?

A total of 196 respondents reported 266 children across all age groups, reflecting that many households have more than one child. The distribution shows that most households with children under 3 have one child, while households with school-aged children are more likely to have multiple children.

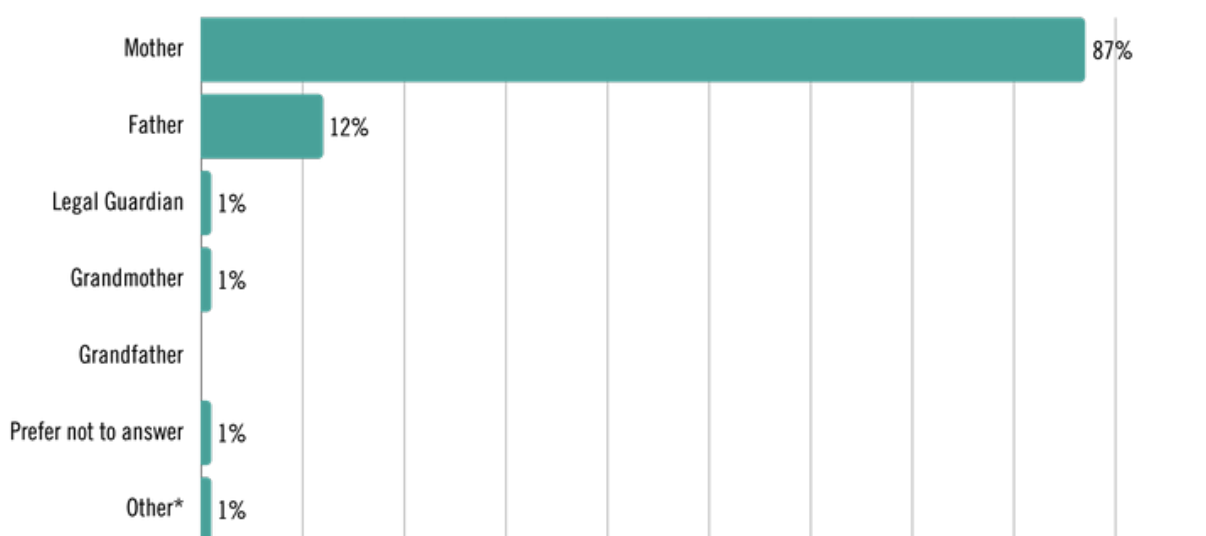
Answered: 196 Skipped: 51



Responses indicating four or more children were negligible (0%) and are not shown.

Q7: What is your relationship to these children? Check all that apply.

Answered: 194 Skipped: 53



*Other = Extended family (e.g., aunt) and Non-parent caregiver roles.



Was lucky to get a spot a month or so before returning to work, and was considering not being able to return. Before getting a spot, I spent many hours contacting care facilities since birth (can't go on a list before birth - as a planner this stressed me out a lot during pregnancy). I was on all the waitlists but told I wouldn't likely get anything until my child was 3.



Q8: Besides you and any children aged 0 to 12, who else is currently living in your household? Check all that apply.

Most respondents live in households with a spouse or partner, while a smaller number reported extended family or additional adults. This indicates that childcare needs are primarily being managed within two-adult households, with limited additional in-home support.

Answered: 194 Skipped: 53



“ We’re trying to make the move to Revelstoke long term and I’m working here and commuting on weekends because we can’t find full-time childcare for our toddler to make the move as a family. ”

SECTION 3.2

EMPLOYMENT & WORK PATTERNS

Why childcare is essential.

This section outlines the employment patterns of respondents and their partners, including work status, locations, and schedules. These factors shape childcare needs and highlight the role of childcare in supporting workforce participation.

Work patterns shape both the need for – and access to – childcare.

Section Snapshot

64%

FULL-TIME WORK

respondents working full-time

89%

DUAL-INCOME

partners working full-time

28%

HOURS VARY

variable or shift-based schedules

Key Findings

- Dual-income households are the norm
- Work is typically year-round and full-time
- Many jobs involve variable or non-standard schedules

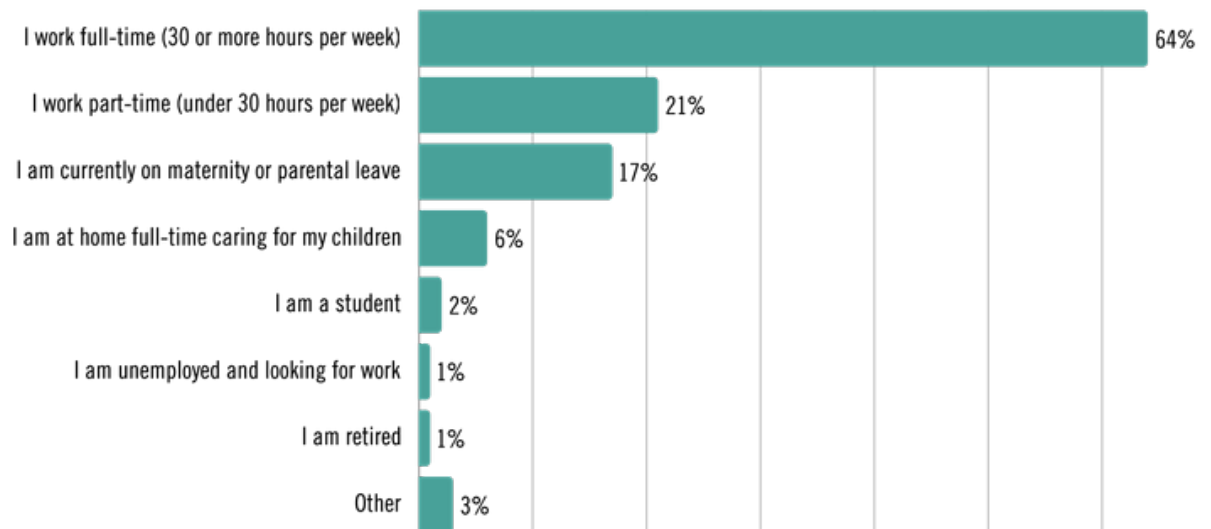


System Failure: Childcare options do not align with non-standard or shift-based work.

Pressure Point: Parents face gaps when returning from parental leave.

Q9: What is your work/study situation? Check all that apply.

Answered: 191 Skipped: 56



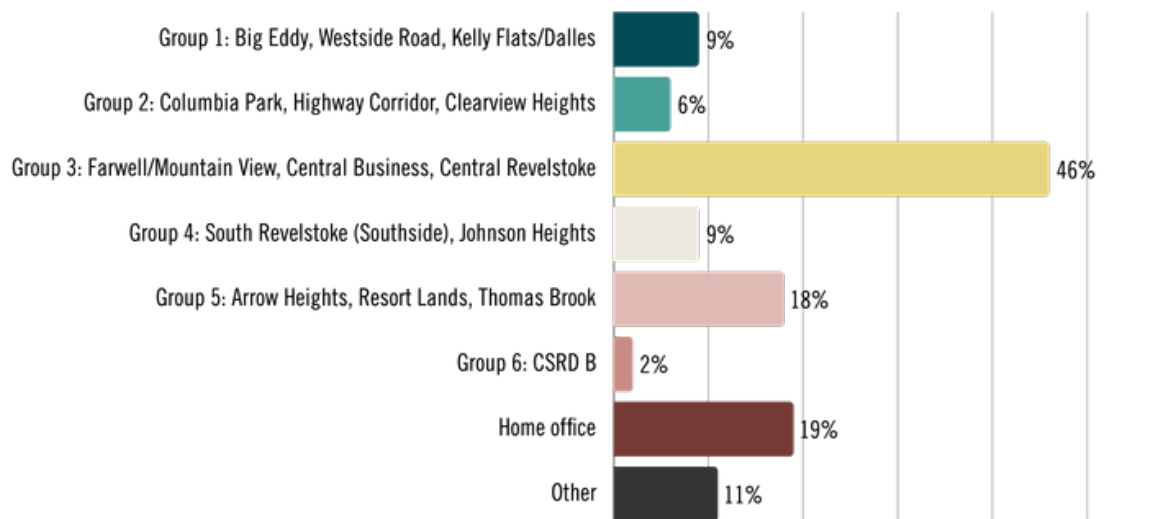
Additional work situations identified through “Other” responses (3%):

- Non-standard work schedules (e.g., shift work, seasonal employment)
- Combining multiple roles (e.g., part-time work, studying, casual positions)
- Working multiple jobs
- Delayed or limited workforce participation due to lack of childcare
- Intent to return to full-time work contingent on childcare availability

“ On maternity leave but will go back full-time if we can get childcare. ”

Q10: Where do you do your paid work? (Skip if not applicable)

Answered: 180 Skipped: 67



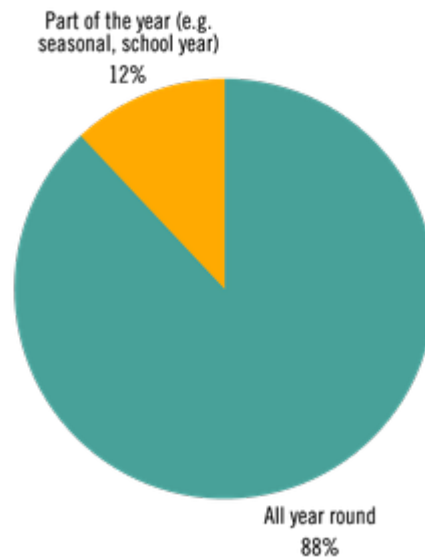
Additional work patterns identified through “Other” responses (11%):

- Working across multiple locations within Revelstoke (e.g., construction, education, mobile roles)
- Commuting or traveling outside the community for work (e.g., Shelter Bay, Salmon Arm, Okanagan, out-of-province)
- Hybrid work arrangements combining home-based and external work
- Employment tied to major regional employers or specific sites (e.g., dam, rail, tourism operations)
- Multiple jobs with varying work locations

“ Home office
and out of town. ”

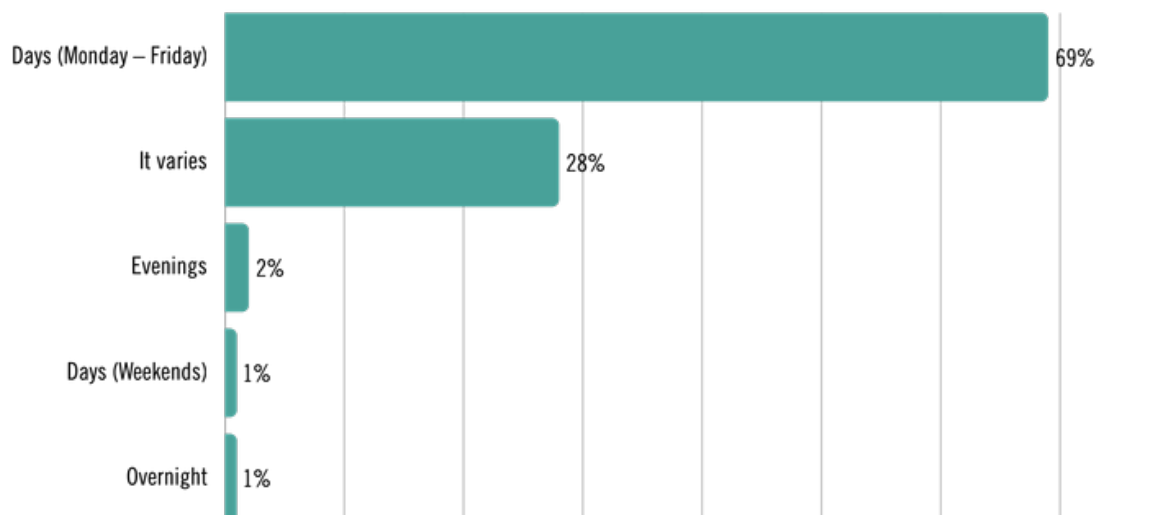
Q11: Is your paid work year round or part of the year (e.g. seasonal, school year): (Skip if not applicable)

Answered: 182 Skipped: 65



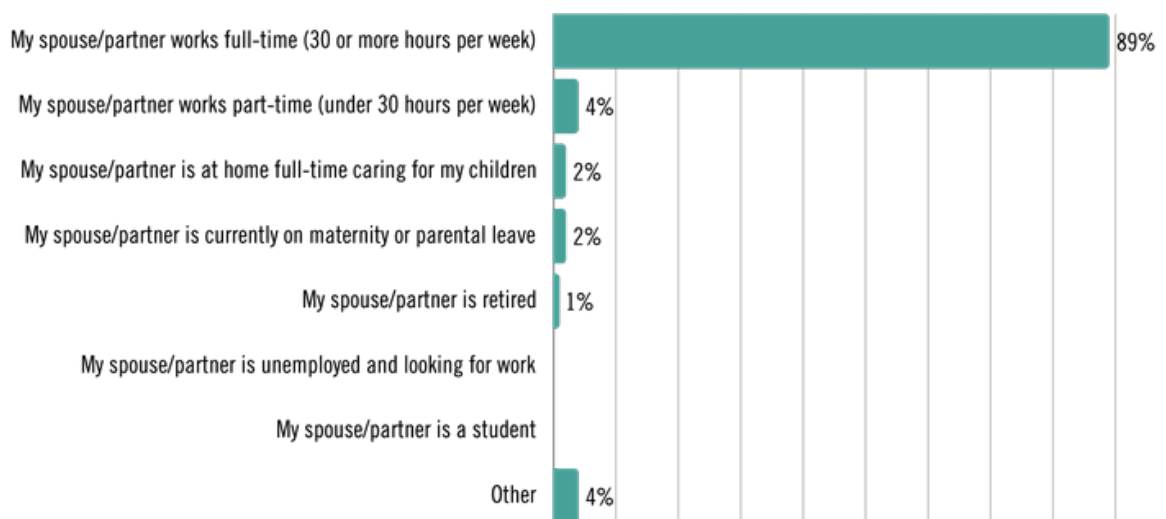
Q12: When do you do your paid work? Check one only. (Skip if not applicable)

Answered: 181 Skipped: 66



Q13: What is your spouse/partner's work/study situation? Check all that apply.

Answered: 180 Skipped: 67



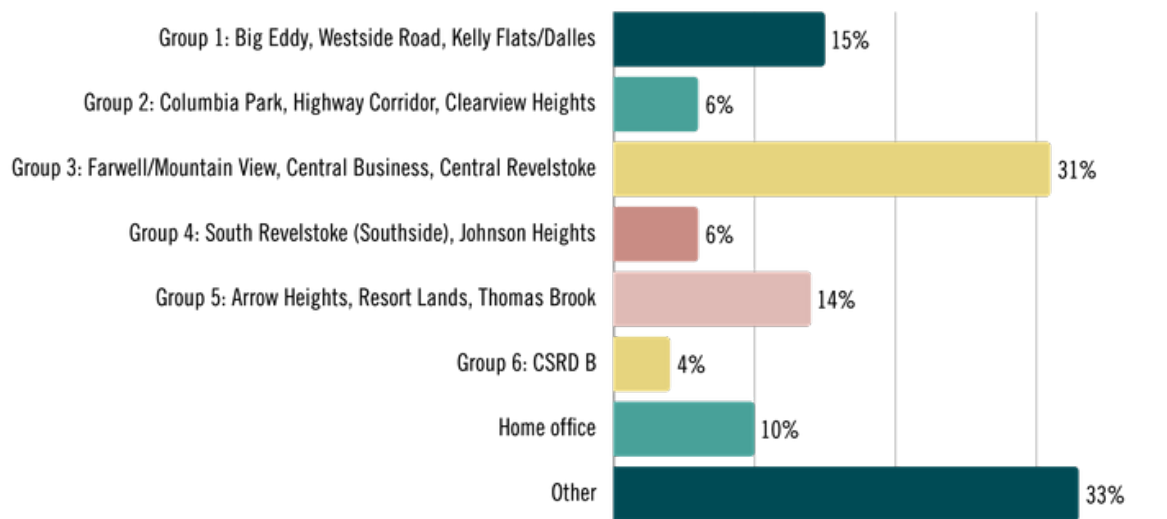
Additional situations identified through “Other” responses (4%):

- Single-parent households or no spouse/partner
- Unable to work due to disability
- Non-standard or demanding work schedules (e.g., extended shifts, irregular hours)
- Seasonal employment with fluctuating hours and workload

“ Seasonal. Summer works over 60 hrs a week. ”

Q14: Where does your spouse/partner do their paid work?

Answered: 177 Skipped: 70



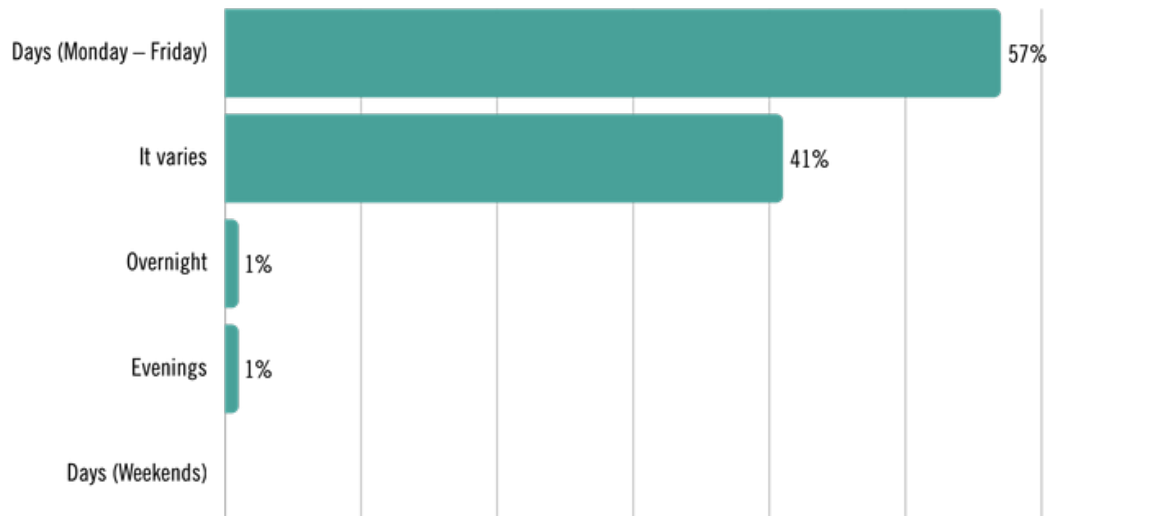
Additional work patterns identified through “Other” responses (33%):

- Working across multiple locations within Revelstoke (e.g., construction, trades, mobile roles)
- Regular travel or employment outside the community (e.g., regional, provincial, or fly-in/fly-out work)
- Seasonal and tourism-based work involving varied locations
- Remote or field-based work (e.g., forestry, guiding, environmental or resource sectors)
- Multiple jobs with different or changing work locations
- Non-fixed or highly variable workplaces
- Single-parent households or no spouse/partner

“ Does a variety of work across Revelstoke and the Interior of BC. ”

Q15: When does your spouse/partner do their paid work? Check one only.

Answered: 175 Skipped: 72



SECTION 3.3

ACCESS, AVAILABILITY, & CURRENT USE

Where the system is not meeting demand.

This section examines how families access childcare and the barriers they face. It includes insights on current arrangements, waitlists, and the impact of limited availability on the ability to secure care. ***Demand continues to exceed supply across all age groups, especially under 3.***

Section Snapshot

71%

WORKFORCE

unable to return to work (n=182)

54%

WAITING NOW

currently waiting for care (n=121)

85%

EXPERIENCE

have been on a waitlist (n=99)

Key Findings

- Waitlists are widespread and often extend 1–3+ years
- Families rely on informal or temporary care arrangements
- Infant and toddler spaces are extremely limited

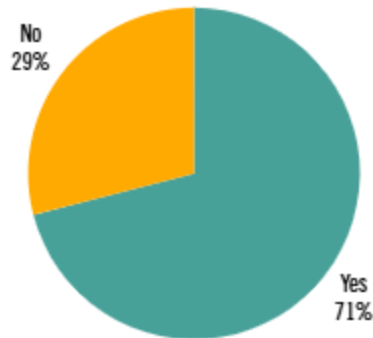


System Failure: Childcare shortages are preventing workforce participation.

Pressure Point: Families rely on patchwork arrangements while waiting for care.

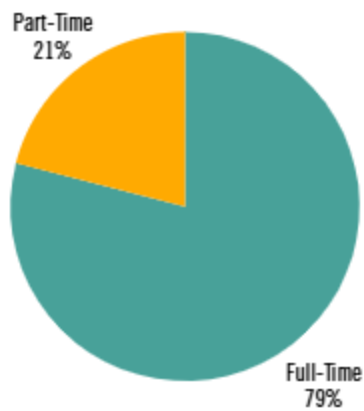
Q16: Has your household been affected by a lack of available childcare that has forced you or your spouse/partner to not be able to return to work?

Answered: 182 Skipped: 65



Q17: Has this affected you or your spouse/partner's ability to not be able to return to work full-time or part-time?

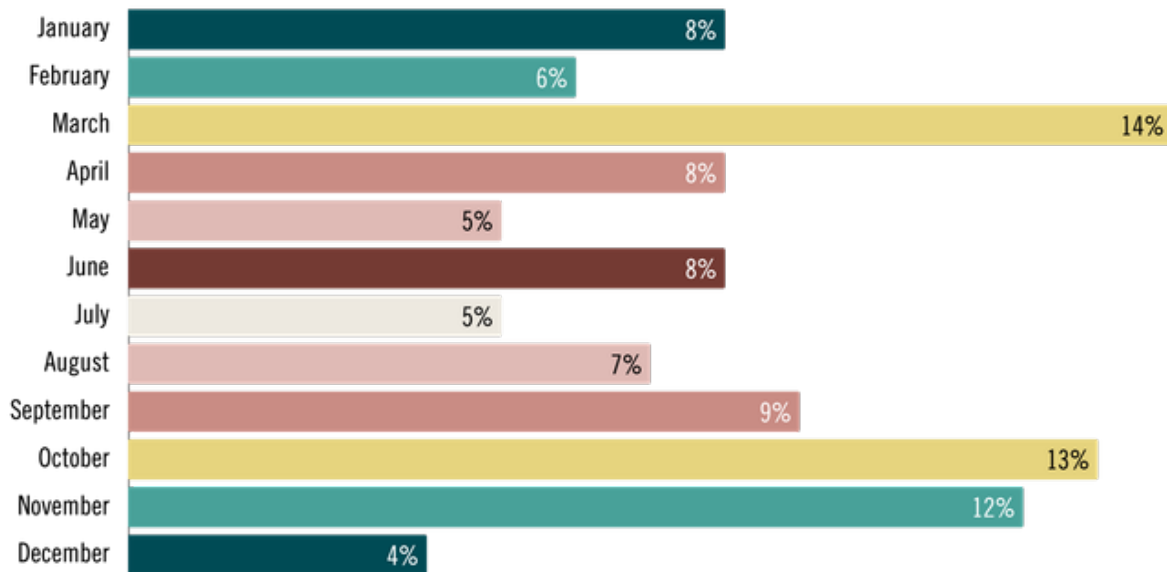
Answered: 151 Skipped: 96



Among respondents who indicated they were impacted, 79% reported difficulty returning to full-time work, while 21% reported difficulty returning to part-time work.

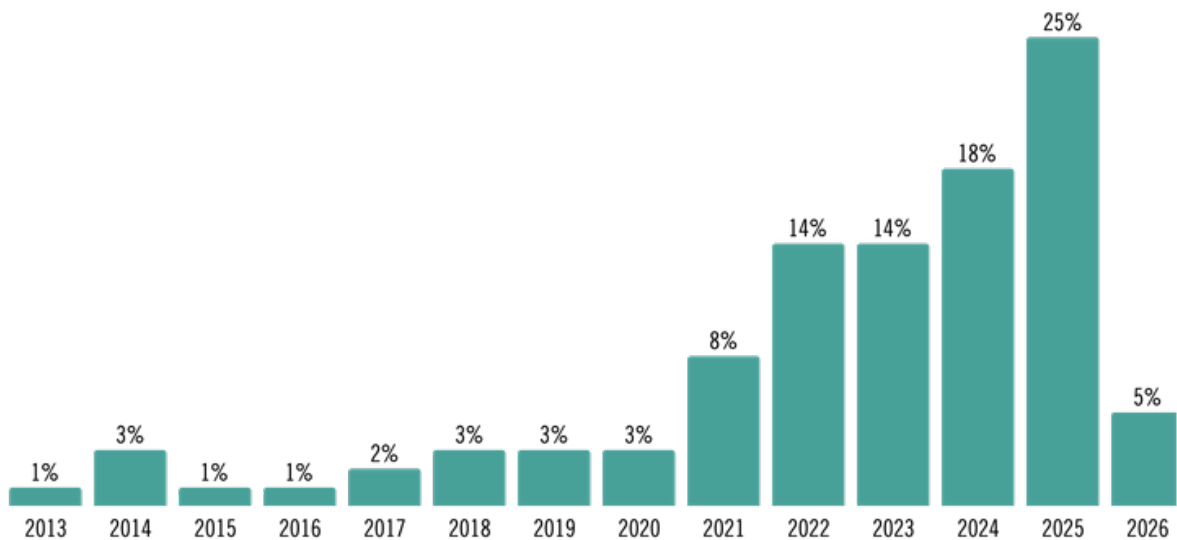
Q18: What's your child's Birth Month?

Answered: 153 Skipped: 94



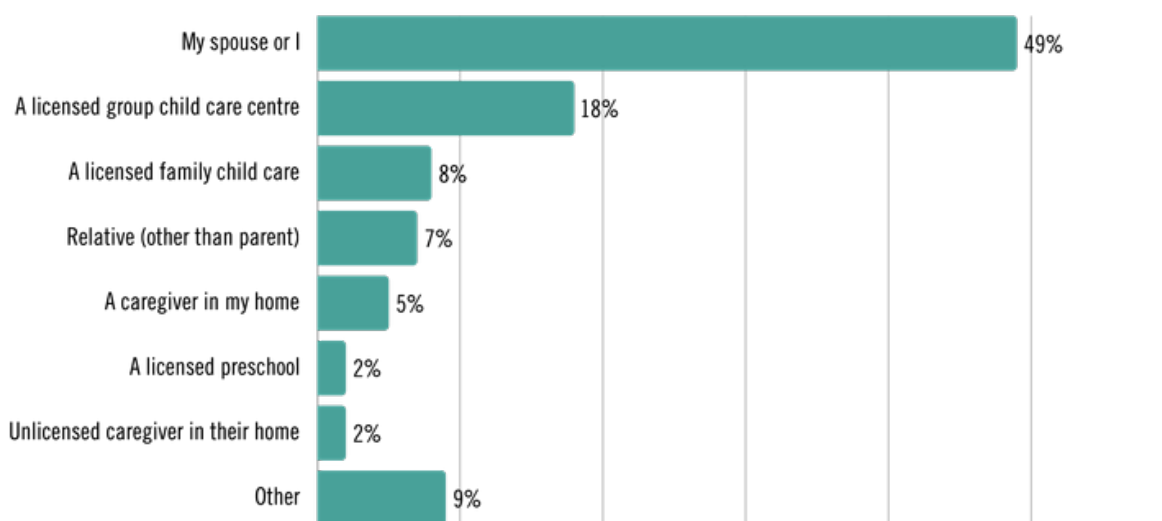
Q19: What's your child's Birth Year?

Answered: 153 Skipped: 94



Q20: What is the primary care arrangement for this child (i.e., the one you use the most, excluding school)?

Answered: 157 Skipped: 90



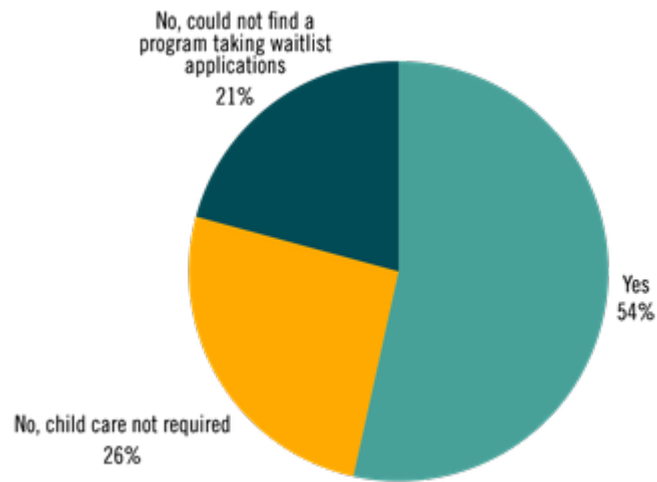
Additional situations identified through “Other” responses (9%):

- Temporary parental care (e.g., maternity/parental leave) while seeking childcare
- Delayed access to childcare, including extended wait times before securing a space
- Use of nannies or in-home care, often noted as costly or difficult to maintain
- Transitional or uncertain arrangements (e.g., planning future care, interim solutions)
- Supplementary or specialized supports within licensed settings
- Before or after-school care arrangements

“ I am on maternity leave but have tried to get her into daycare for the fall but so far unsuccessful. The earlier questions of “has lack of daycare impacted us going back to work” is hard to answer but I’m stressed about it as we have no care lined up but I need to go back to work financially for our family. ”

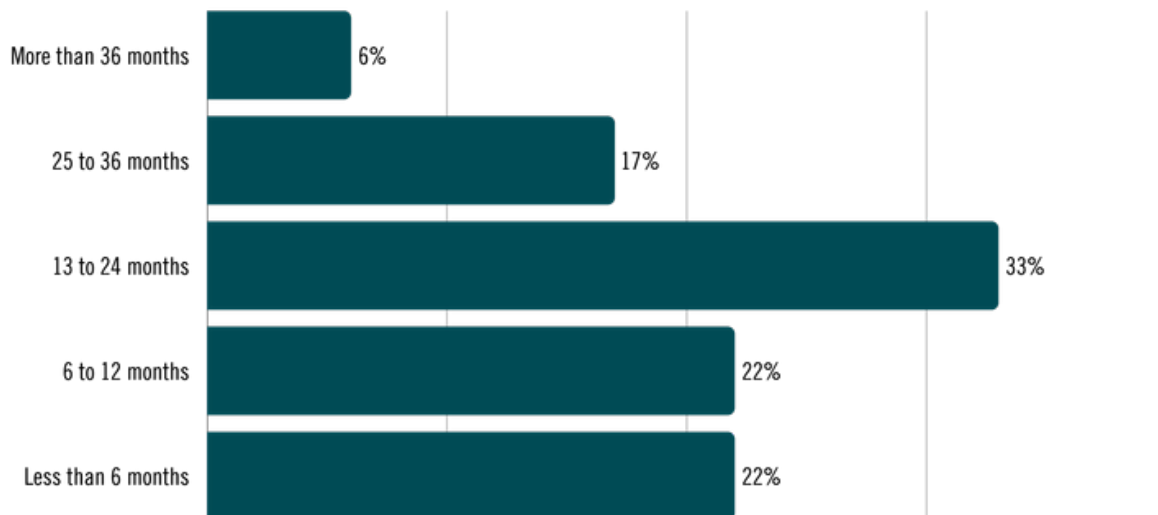
Q21: Is this child currently on a waitlist for childcare?

Answered: 121 Skipped: 126



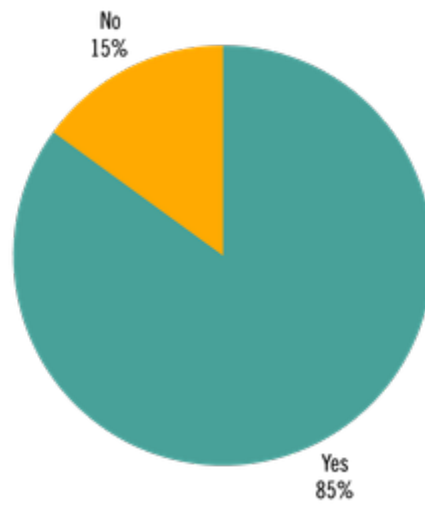
Q22: How long has this child been on a waitlist?

Answered: 72 Skipped: 175



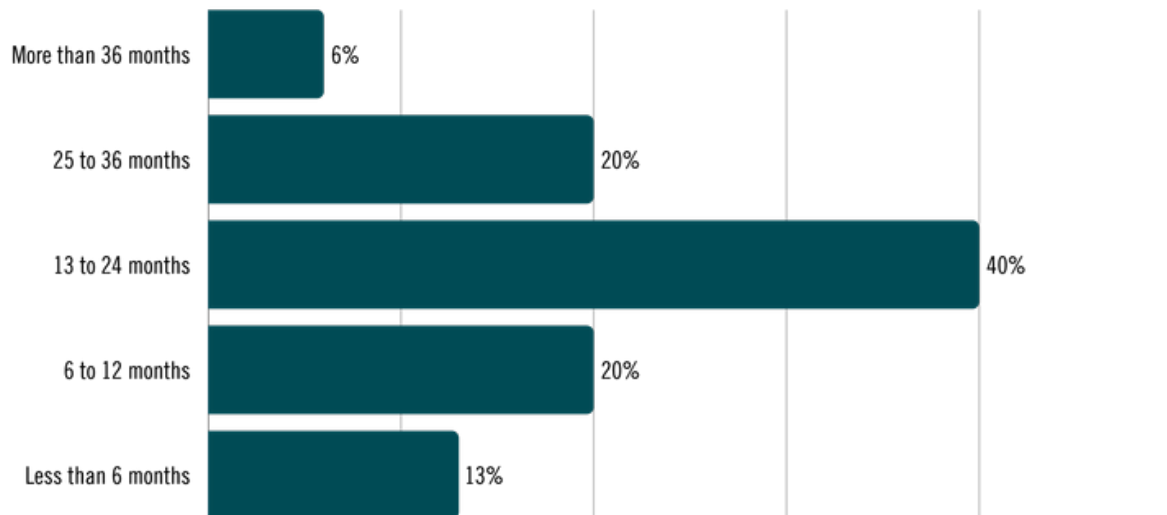
Q23: Was this child ever on a waitlist for childcare?

Answered: 99 Skipped: 148



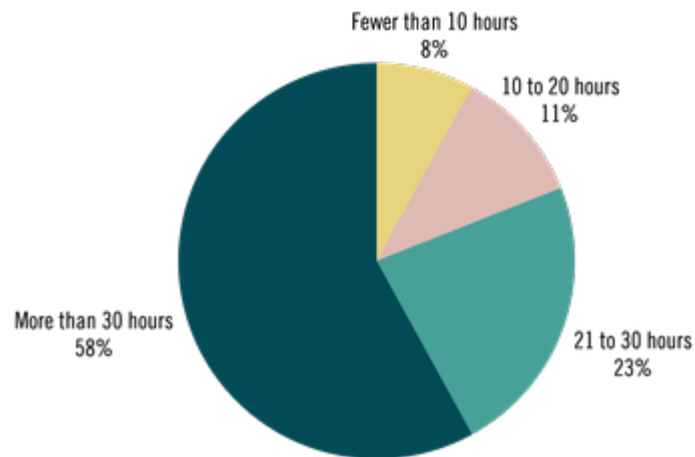
Q24: If yes, for how long?

Answered: 83 Skipped: 164



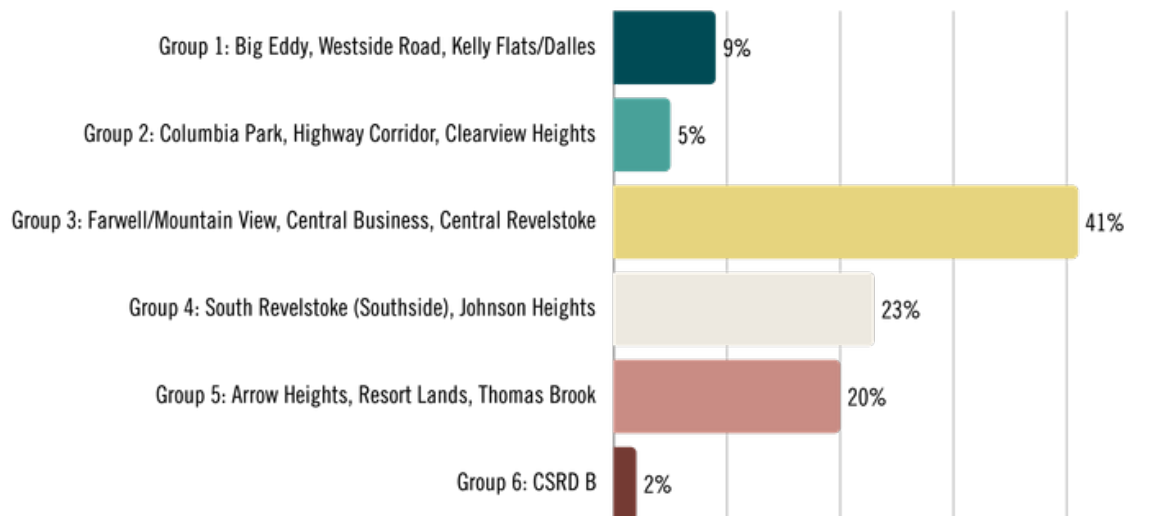
Q25: In an average week, how many hours does this child spend in his or her primary childcare arrangement?

Answered: 91 Skipped: 156



Q26: In which community is this child's primary childcare arrangement located?

Answered: 88 Skipped: 159



SECTION 3.4

EXPERIENCE, BARRIERS & SATISFACTION

What families are experiencing.

This section explores the lived experience of navigating childcare in Revelstoke, including how arrangements are chosen, levels of satisfaction, and the challenges families encounter when seeking care. ***Finding childcare is widely described as stressful, uncertain, and time-consuming.***

Section Snapshot

86%

DIFFICULT FIND

report childcare is hard to access

MAJ

VERY DIFFICULT

describe process as highly challenging

CHOICE

NOT AVAILABLE

decisions driven by availability

Key Findings

- Families frequently navigate long waitlists with limited communication
- Care is often chosen based on availability, not preference
- Many arrangements are temporary or unstable



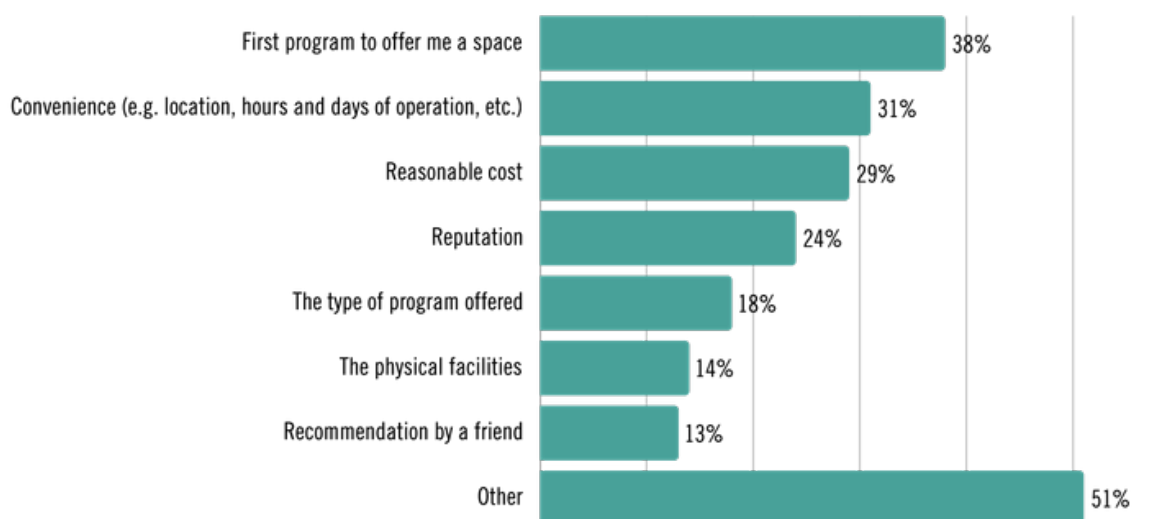
System Failure: The system lacks transparency in access and waitlist processes.

Strength: When accessed, childcare quality and staff relationships are highly valued.

Findings reflect responses from families across Revelstoke; response counts vary by question.

Q27: Why did you choose this arrangement? Check all that apply.

Answered: 87 Skipped: 160



Additional factors identified through “Other” open-ended responses (51%):

Childcare decisions are largely driven by scarcity, not preference. Many families are forced into whatever arrangement is available, delaying work, relying on unpaid care, or patching together temporary solutions—pointing to significant gaps in access, affordability, and appropriate care.

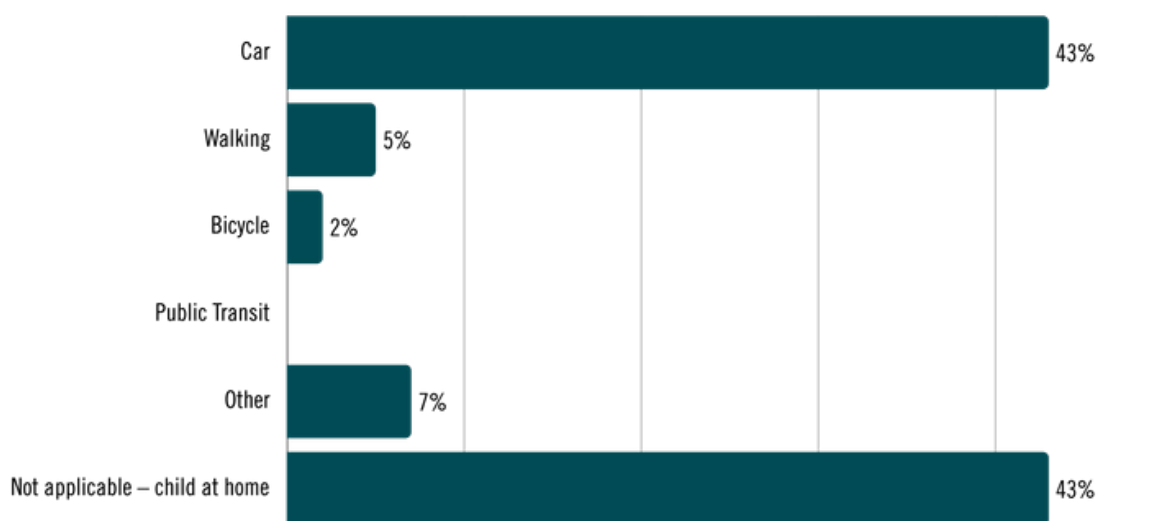
A significant proportion of respondents indicated that their childcare arrangement was not a true choice, but the result of limited or unavailable options. Many families reported accepting the only space available, being unable to secure care for infants, or facing waitlists lasting months or years.

Parents frequently describe staying home longer than planned or delaying return to work altogether due to lack of childcare. In some cases, one parent remained out of the workforce entirely because no viable care could be found.

Barriers were particularly pronounced for children with additional needs, with families reporting difficulty finding programs able to provide appropriate support. Work schedules also played a major role, with shift work and non-standard hours making most childcare options unworkable.

Q28: How does this child typically get to and from childcare? Choose one only.

Answered: 98 Skipped: 149



Additional arrangements identified through “Other” responses (7%)

- Combination of transportation methods
- Different drop-off and pick-up arrangements
- Transportation connected to school or program locations
- Support-assisted transportation



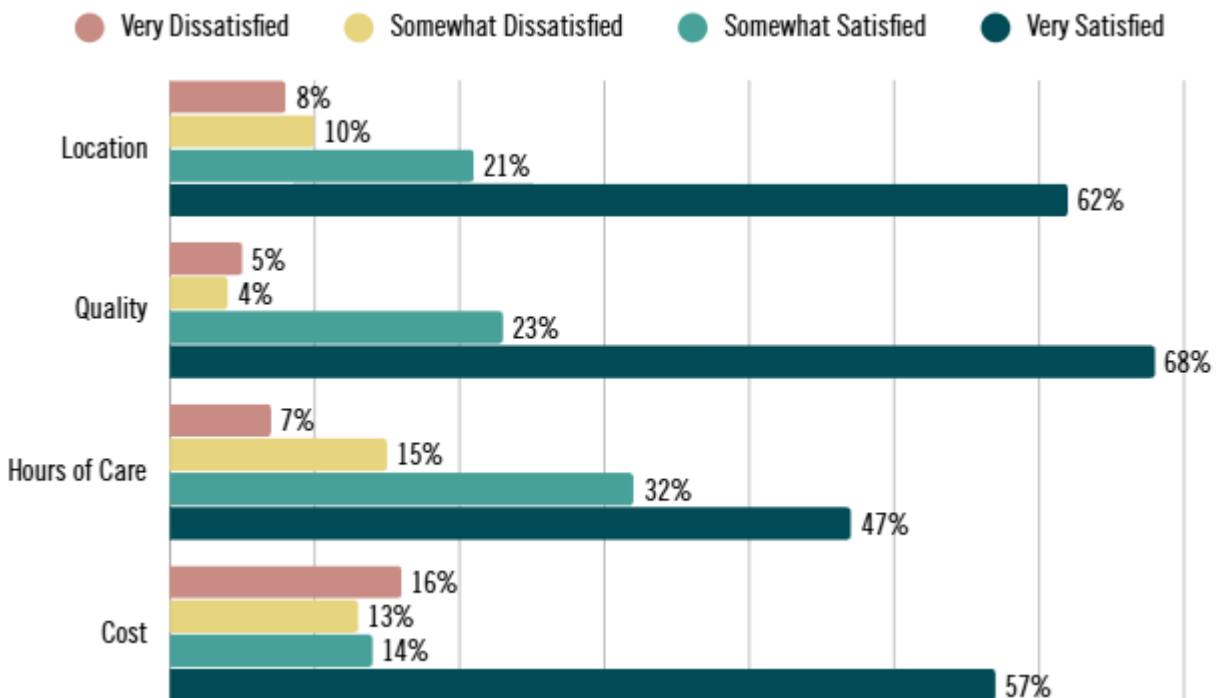
Parent walks child in the morning, and a parent picks up by vehicle at the end of the day.



Q29: How satisfied are you with the following aspects of this child's primary care arrangement?

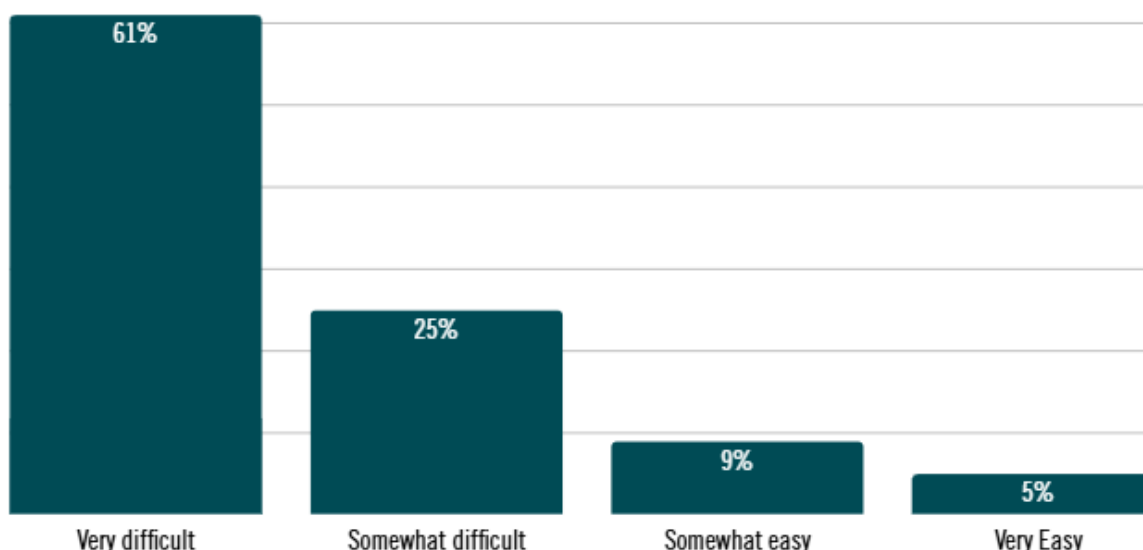
Respondents report generally high levels of satisfaction with their current childcare arrangements, particularly in terms of quality and cost, although satisfaction with hours of care is comparatively lower.

Answered: 79 Skipped: 168



Q30: How easy or difficult was it to find care for this child?

Answered: 85 Skipped: 162



Q31: If difficult, please explain briefly why

Answered: 76 Skipped: 171

Parents consistently describe the process of finding childcare in Revelstoke as very difficult, time-consuming, and often unsuccessful. Many report being placed on multiple waitlists—sometimes as early as pregnancy—only to face waits of one to three years or more with little or no communication. In many cases, families never receive a response or any indication of where they stand on a list, making it nearly impossible to plan for a return to work or make informed decisions about care.

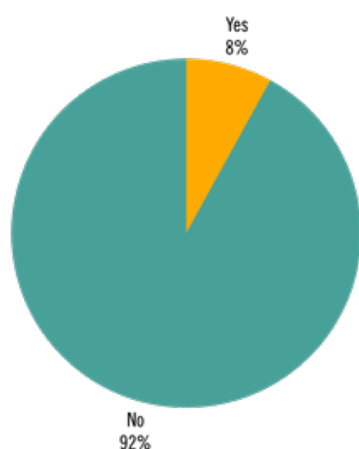
A significant number (55-60%) of respondents indicated that they were unable to secure licensed childcare at all. This challenge is especially pronounced for children under the age of three, where availability is described as extremely limited. Families frequently report being told that waitlists are full or closed entirely and others describe inconsistent or unclear processes, with some perceiving that access to spaces depends on personal connections or timing rather than a transparent system.

As a result, families are relying on a range of alternative and often unsustainable solutions. These include depending on relatives for long-term care, hiring private nannies or au pairs at significant cost, coordinating work schedules between parents, or using temporary or unlicensed care arrangements. In many cases, one parent reduces their hours, delays returning to work, or leaves the workforce entirely due to a lack of available care.

Despite these challenges, there is consistent positive feedback when families are able to secure childcare. Many respondents describe their eventual placements as high quality, with trusted providers and strong programming. However, these positive experiences are often framed as the result of persistence, timing, or luck, rather than a system that is functioning predictably or equitably.

Q32: Does this child have a special need or disability?

Answered: 142 Skipped: 105

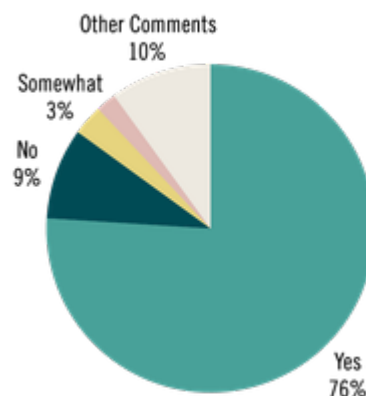


A small but important proportion of respondents (11) report that their child has a special need or disability, highlighting the need for inclusive childcare options and accessible supports within the system.

Q33: Does your child's current care arrangement meet the ability needs of your child?

Answered: 90 Skipped: 157

Most respondents (76%) indicate their child's current care meets their needs; however, per the open-ended comments, many note this is dependent on temporary arrangements such as parental leave, family care, or personal trade-offs. Among those reporting unmet needs, concerns focus on lack of appropriate programs, limited social interaction, and care that does not align with work or developmental needs—suggesting many current solutions are not sustainable long term.



SECTION 3.5

PREFERENCES, NEEDS & DECISION FACTORS

What families need – and what is missing.

This section identifies the types of childcare families prefer and the conditions needed to better support them. It highlights gaps between current options and what families would choose if accessible and affordable care were available.

What families need is clear – but current options do not meet demand.

Section Snapshot

60%

WOULD CHANGE

if better options
existed (n=130)

#1

LICENSED CARE

first choice
childcare type

28%

HOURS VARY

variable or shift-
based schedules

Key Findings

- Families prefer licensed, structured childcare
- Full-time weekday care is most needed
- Flexible and extended hours are in high demand



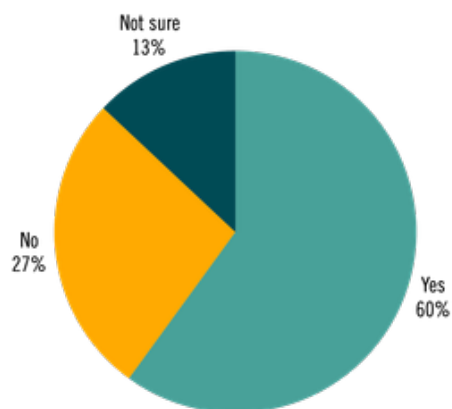
System Failure: Most families are not in their preferred childcare arrangement.

Pressure Point: Flexible and non-standard care options remain limited despite demand.

Findings reflect responses from families across Revelstoke; response counts vary by question.

Q34: Would you change this child's care arrangement(s) if a preferred option became available at a price you could afford?

Answered: 130 Skipped: 117



Q35: If yes, why?

Answered: 70 Skipped: 177

Most respondents indicated they would change their childcare arrangement due to cost, lack of access to preferred licensed care, and the need for more reliable and consistent options. Many current arrangements are described as financially unsustainable, limiting work participation or forcing families into temporary or less suitable care. Here's some perspective from the 70 respondents:



"We are planning a part-time nanny to allow me (mother) to return to work part time. This is not financially practical in the short term, but will prevent me from losing my professional designation from being off for too long."

"I would love to return full time to my career and have my child in a centre that encourages creative learning, outdoor based play etc. to help them develop. I need to work in order to afford my mortgage."

"We pay \$22 an hour, 40 hours a week. It's crazy expensive, and I'm only working because I want to keep my job long term, not because it makes financial sense."

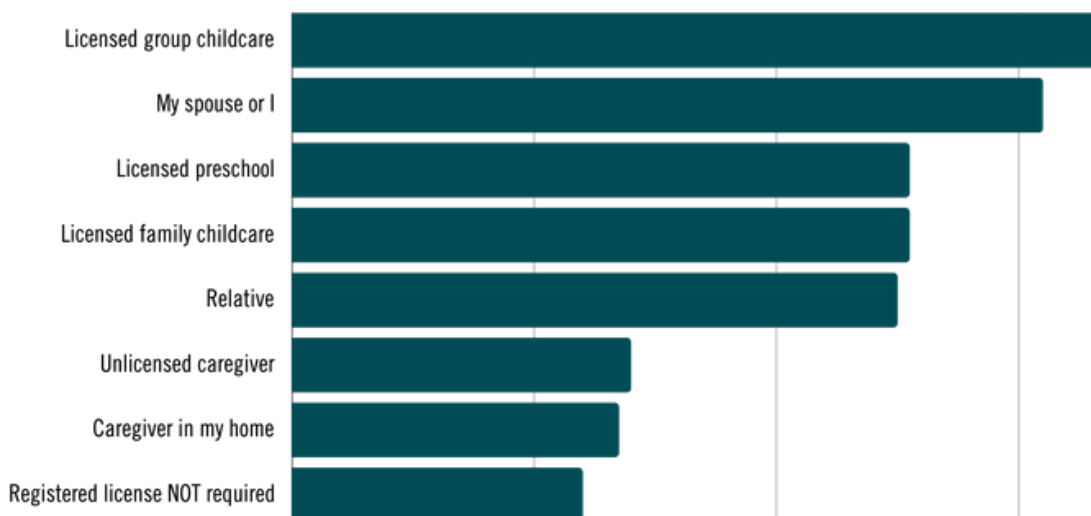
"We were never provided the luxury of choosing a daycare based on facility quality, care providers, time outside, or suitability for our family and child. I would much prefer to have my child socializing with a larger group of kids in a daycare facility. The high cost of privatized care is unsustainable for us, which necessitates the need to continue searching for more affordable options—often leading to high levels of stress due to uncertainty."



Q36: If yes, what would be your preferred options? Rank your preferences.

Licensed group childcare was the preferred option overall, followed closely by care provided by a parent or spouse, with other options showing lower relative preference.

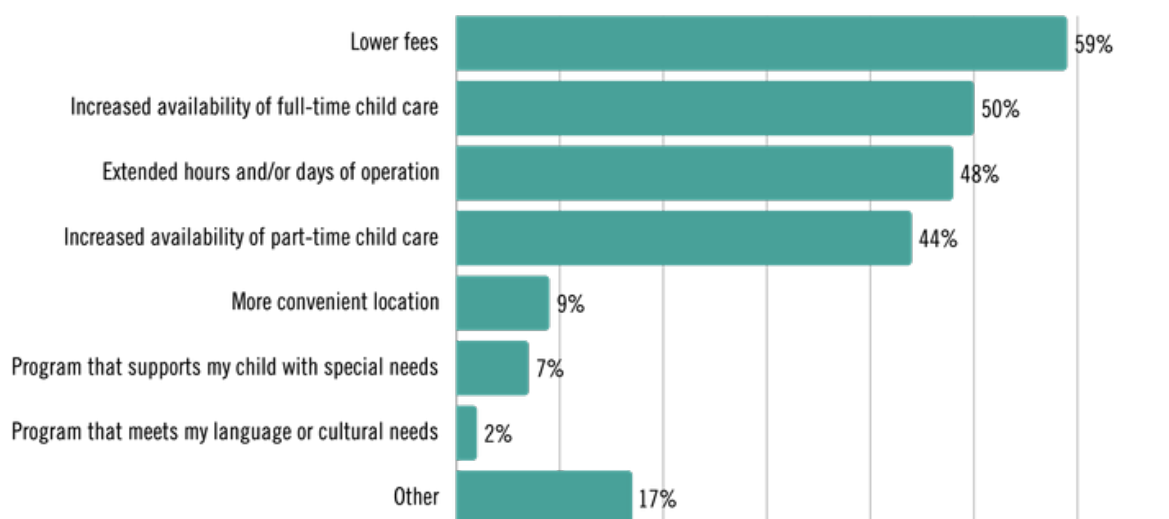
Answered: 153 Skipped: 94



“ We were never provided the luxury of choosing a daycare based on facility quality, care providers, time outside, or suitability for our family and child. I would much prefer to have my child socializing with a larger group of kids in a daycare facility. The high cost of privatized care is unsustainable for us, which necessitates the need to continue searching for more affordable options- often leading to high levels of stress due to uncertainty. ”

Q37: What would help improve your current childcare situation? Check all that apply.

Answered: 126 Skipped: 121



Additional needs identified through “Other” responses (17%):

- Increased availability, particularly for infants/toddlers and across all age groups
- Spaces that can accommodate siblings within the same program
- More physical childcare facilities and licensed spaces
- Improved programming for school-aged children, including more engaging and age-appropriate options
- Greater variety in programming (e.g., outdoor/forest-based, structured programming)
- Access to childcare outside the home or informal settings
- Expanded support for children with additional needs
- Continued concerns around affordability and access to subsidized care

A small number of respondents indicated they are currently satisfied with their childcare situation, often after securing a space following extended wait times.



Increased programming for older children.



Q38: What would be your ideal childcare arrangement for this child?

Ideal childcare arrangements are largely out of reach for many families, with respondents consistently describing a gap between what is needed - affordable, reliable, full-time care, and what is currently available in the community. Key themes include:

- Full-time, Monday-Friday care aligned with standard working hours is the most common preference
- Affordable or subsidized care (e.g., \$10/day) is a critical requirement for many families
- Increased access to licensed group childcare with qualified staff and structured programming
- Greater availability of care for infants and toddlers (under 18 months)
- Flexible options, including part-time care and arrangements that accommodate varying schedules
- Extended hours and non-standard care to support shift work and early/late workdays
- Reliable and consistent care, reducing the need for temporary or unstable arrangements
- More after-school and school-age programming, including transportation to activities
- Opportunities for socialization, peer interaction, and age-appropriate development
- Program variety, including outdoor/forest-based care and structured learning environments
- Ability to secure care for multiple children within the same program
- For some families, the ideal would be the ability to stay home, if financially feasible

Overall, ideal arrangements reflect a system that is affordable, accessible, consistent, developmentally appropriate, and aligned with real-world work schedules—conditions many families indicated are currently not being met.

Q39: What do you like most about your current childcare arrangements?

Answered: 57 Skipped: 190

Even in a constrained system, families find value in their current arrangements - most often in the quality of care, flexibility, and the ability to spend time with their children - but many of these positives are tied to arrangements that are temporary, informal, or not sustainable long term.

- Strong appreciation for caring, attentive providers and high-quality relationships between caregivers and children
- Value placed on children being happy, safe, and well cared for
- Importance of flexibility, especially for families with non-standard or shift work schedules
- Appreciation for affordability, particularly when care is subsidized or lower cost
- Positive experiences with small group settings and family-like environments
- High value placed on outdoor time, community engagement, and varied activities
- Convenience factors such as location, hours, and reliability of care
- Gratitude for simply having access to childcare at all, regardless of type
- Many families value the ability to care for their own children or have family involved, especially in early years
- Some arrangements support better work-life balance, including more sleep or reduced logistical challenges
- One-on-one or small group care is appreciated for individual attention and consistency
- Several responses highlight arrangements that work well now but are not financially or practically sustainable
- Some families noted lack of consistent or permanent arrangements, even when aspects of care are positive

Q40: What would you like to change about your current childcare arrangements?

Answered: 57 Skipped: 190

Families are not looking for minor improvements - responses point to fundamental gaps in cost, availability, and fit with real work schedules, with many parents unable to access enough care to work or relying on arrangements that are unsustainable. Common findings are:

- Lower cost and improved affordability, particularly for full-time care
- Increased availability of licensed childcare and the ability to secure a space
- More consistent and reliable care, reducing reliance on temporary or informal arrangements
- Expanded hours, including earlier drop-off, later pick-up, evenings, and weekends
- Access to full-time care (Monday-Friday) to support workforce participation
- Increased flexibility, including part-time and drop-in options
- More structured, development-focused environments for children
- Greater opportunities for socialization and peer interaction
- Reduced reliance on family, friends, or patchwork care arrangements
- Improved caregiver support and stability (fewer cancellations, more staffing consistency)
- More convenient locations and easier access to activities or transportation
- Additional household support in some in-home care arrangements
- Availability of after-school care for school-aged children
- A desire for permanent, publicly funded or subsidized solutions
- A small number of respondents indicated no changes needed, typically where stable care had been secured

“ If drop-off was a bit earlier,
I could work more full time. ”

Q41: Which of the following sources of information have you used for help in choosing or finding childcare? Check all that apply.

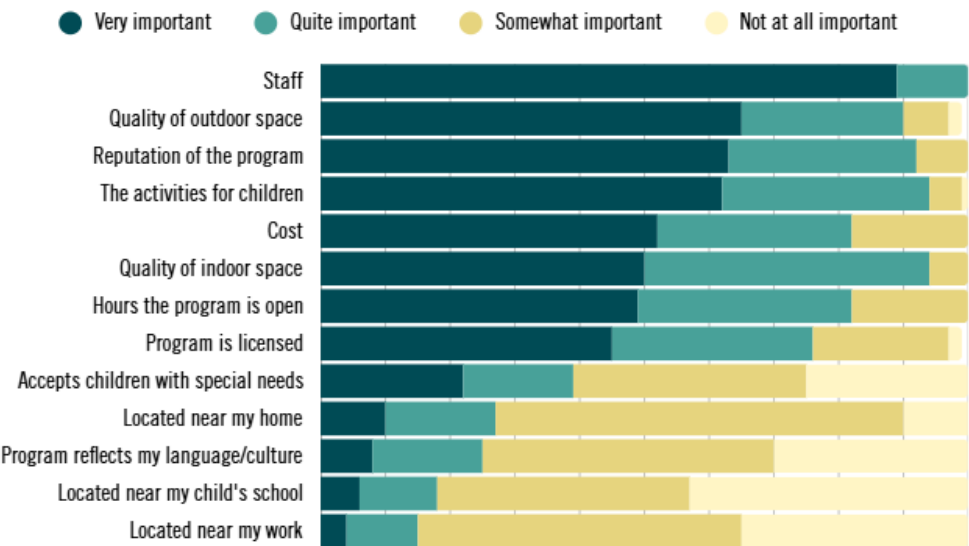
Answered: 78 Skipped: 169



Q42: How important is each of the following aspects of a childcare program for you?

Respondents were asked to rate the importance of various childcare factors. Staff emerged as the most important factor, with majority of respondents rating it as very important. Quality of outdoor space, activities for children, and program reputation were also prioritized, while location-related factors were less consistently rated as important.

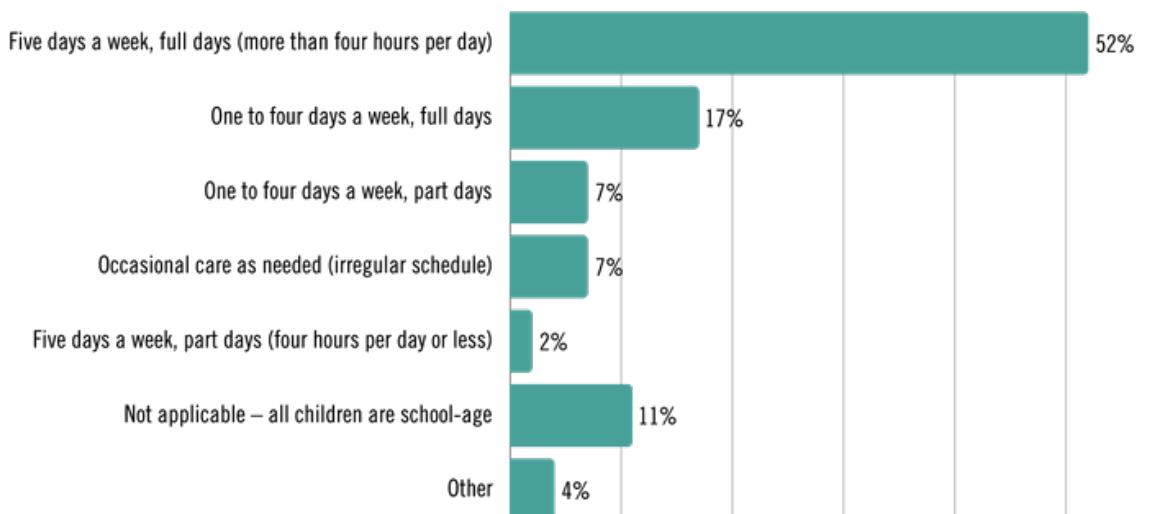
Answered: 84 Skipped: 163



Q43: Which best describes your childcare needs for your children not yet in kindergarten? Check one only.

Childcare needs are primarily full-time and consistent, but a notable portion of families require flexible or variable arrangements, particularly those with non-standard or shifting work schedules - needs that are often difficult to accommodate within existing childcare options.

Answered: 81 Skipped: 166

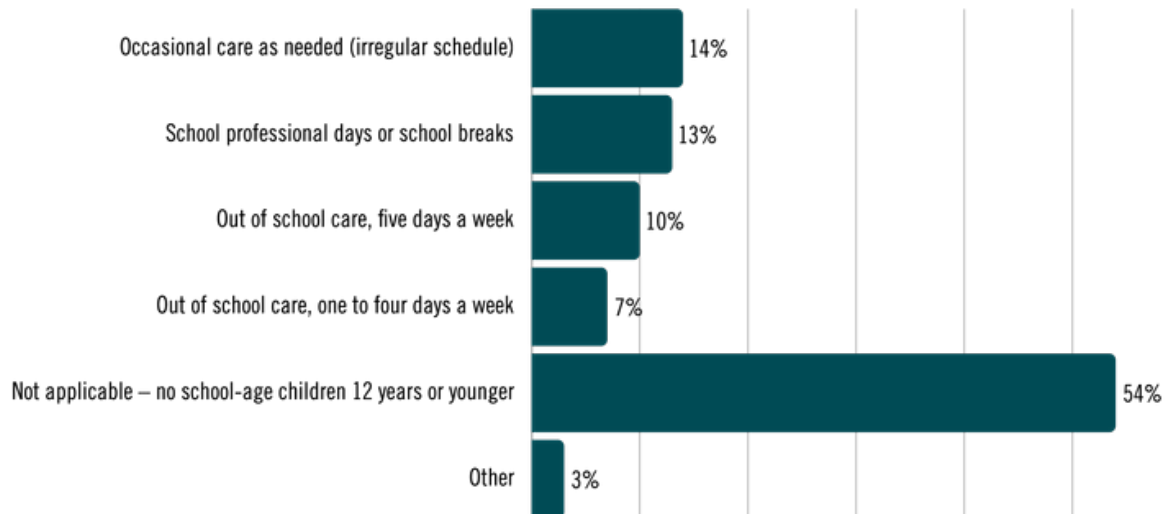


Additional needs identified through “Other” responses (4%):

- Full-time care with some flexibility (e.g., 4-5 days/week depending on availability)
- Combined arrangements (e.g., daycare plus part-time preschool programming)
- Highly variable schedules tied to shift work, with some weeks requiring no care and others needing full or extended days

Q44: Which best describes your childcare needs for your children from kindergarten to 12 years old? Check one only.

Answered: 69 Skipped: 178



Additional needs identified through “Other” responses (3%):

- Care aligned with shift work schedules, required on specific days rather than a consistent weekly schedule

SECTION 3.6

IMPACTS, PRIORITIES & COMMUNITY FEEDBACK

Why it matters.

This section highlights the broader impacts of childcare availability on households and the community, including financial impacts, community priorities, and insights from open-ended responses. **The effects of childcare shortages extend beyond families to the broader economy.**

Section Snapshot

71%

WORKFORCE

impacted ability to work

\$35K

INCOME LOSS

annual household income loss reported

\$3M⁺

COMMUNITY

estimated lost income community-wide

Key Findings

- Families reduce work hours or leave jobs entirely
- Childcare costs create additional financial strain
- Limited childcare reduces workforce availability



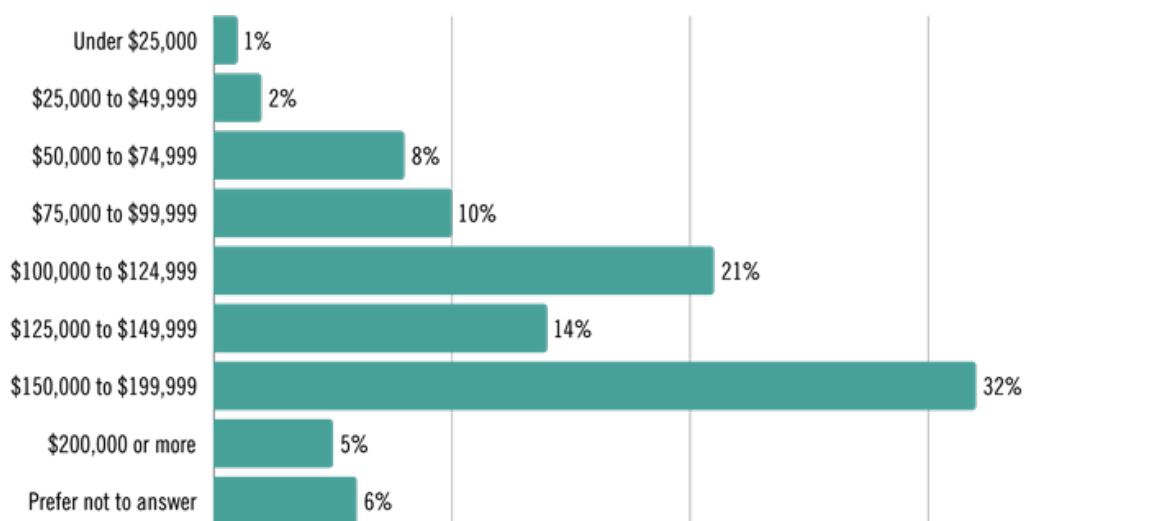
System Failure: Childcare shortages are reducing labour supply and economic activity.

Pressure Point: Families are making significant financial and career sacrifices to manage gaps.

Findings reflect responses from families across Revelstoke; response counts vary by question.

Q45: Last year, what was your total household income, before taxes and deductions?

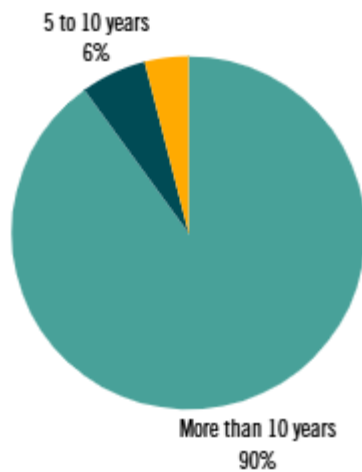
Answered: 84 Skipped: 163



“ I'm super glad there is some movement in this area, with at least analyzing the need. As someone who runs a business, I can also see the large-scale effects on my own staff with having to change how they work due to limited options in town. Previously, I would work downtown and have to either race to childcare pick-up in Arrow Heights or Columbia Park, and it's usually by 5 p.m., or there would be late charges, and that isn't exactly conducive to a typical work schedule. It was a VERY stressful several years. ”

Q46: How long have you lived in Canada?

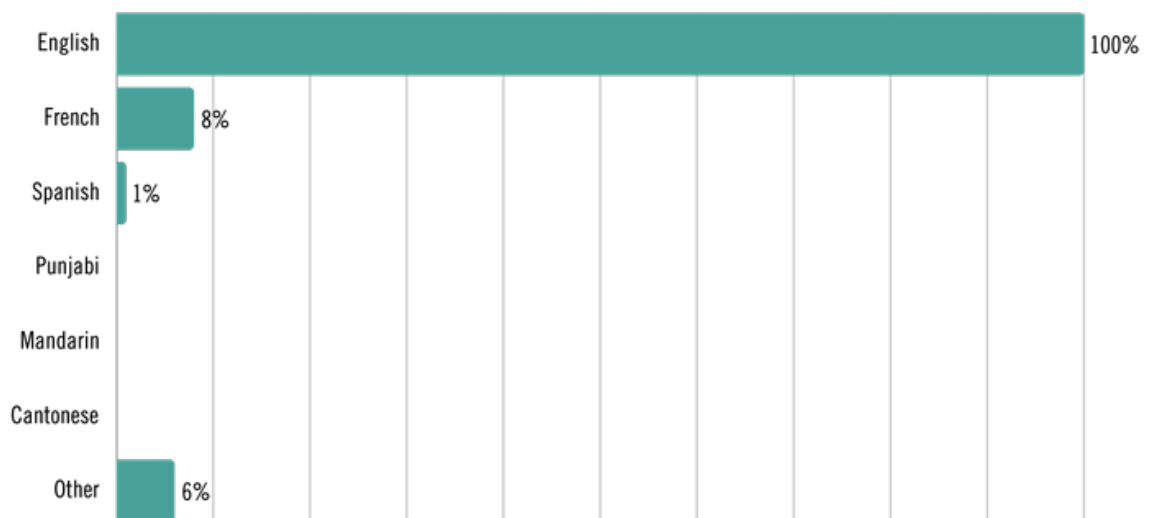
Answered: 84 Skipped: 163



Most respondents (90%) have lived in Canada for more than 10 years, meaning the findings largely reflect long-term residents. A small share has lived in Canada for 5-10 years (6%) or 3-5 years (4%), with no respondents reporting less than three years.

Q47: Which language(s) are most often spoken in your home? Check all that apply.

Answered: 83 Skipped: 164



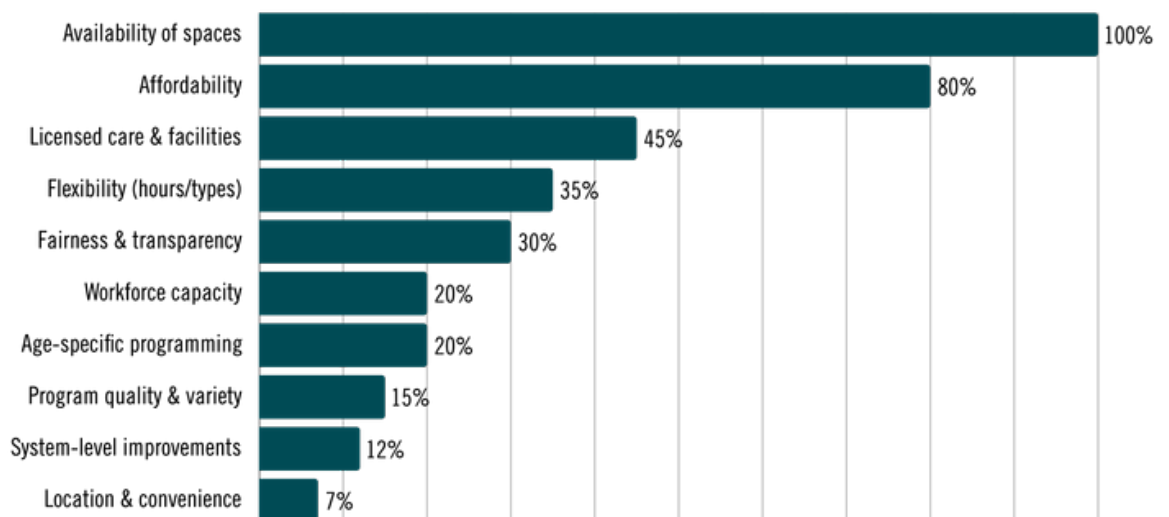
*Other languages (6%), include: German, Czech, Filipino, Japanese

Q48: What are the top three things you'd like to see happen to improve the childcare situation for you and other families in your community?

This data was aggregated from 192 open-ended responses. The most frequently identified priorities were increasing the number of childcare spaces and improving affordability, followed by expanding licensed care and creating more flexible and accessible options. While additional themes such as workforce capacity and program quality were noted, responses were heavily concentrated on the need for more spaces and lower costs. The aggregated response table shows the approximate number of mentions for each prioritized childcare improvement.

Answered: 192

Top Childcare Improvement Priorities (Aggregated Responses):



*Counts are approximate and based on thematic grouping of open-ended responses.

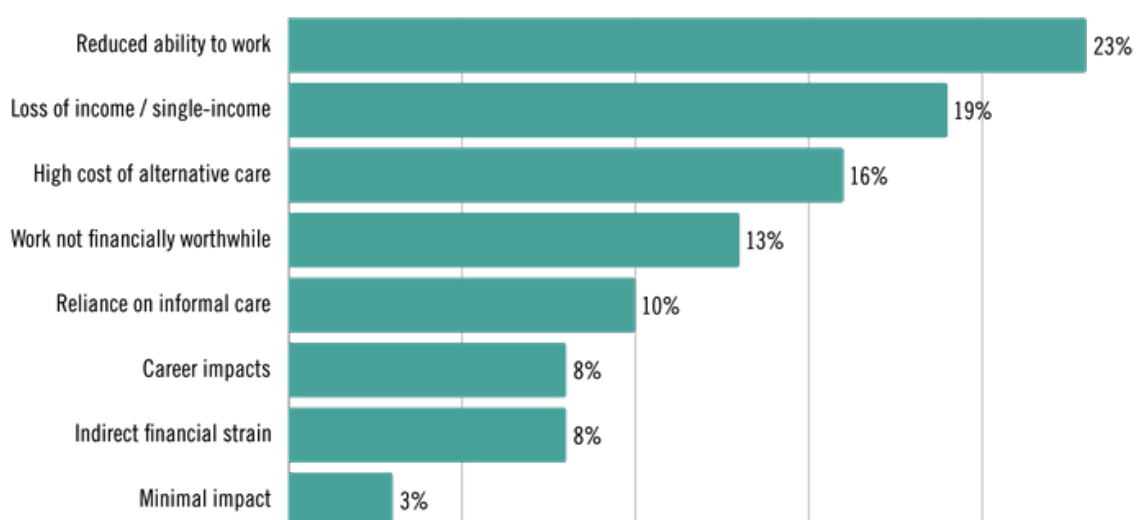
Q49: How has your household been financially impacted by childcare availability in Revelstoke?

Findings show that Childcare availability has a direct and often severe financial impact on households, limiting workforce participation, reducing income, and in many cases making employment financially unviable. Respondents frequently described losing significant amounts of income (with mention upwards of tens of thousands of dollars), leaving jobs, or working primarily to cover childcare costs. For many families, the lack of accessible childcare is not just an inconvenience – it is a defining factor in their financial stability.

The graph below illustrates how these impacts are experienced across households. Counts are approximate and based on thematic grouping of open-ended responses.

Financial Impact from Childcare Availability (Aggregated Responses):

Answered: 54 Skipped: 193



*Counts are approximate and based on thematic grouping of open-ended responses.

“ By not being able to return to work full-time, I am taking a \$35,000 pay cut. In addition, because we don't have a spot in a licensed childcare facility, we are paying a babysitter \$20/hour for about 10 hours per week. This works out to about \$10,000/year. A spot for our child in a full-time, \$10/day care would allow me to work full-time and cost significantly less than our current care. The result would be ~\$40,000 more in our pockets that would in turn be spent at mainly local businesses. I'm sure there are others in similar positions to us who are seeing the lack of available childcare result in significant financial impacts. ”

Q50: Do you have any other comments or suggestions you'd like to share to help with Childcare Assessment and Action Plans for Revelstoke?

Responses to this final question reinforce that childcare challenges in Revelstoke are not isolated issues, but systemic barriers affecting families, employers, and the overall sustainability of the community. Respondents consistently identified lack of access to licensed care, unclear and inequitable waitlist processes, and regulatory barriers to expanding capacity as key pain points. Many described frustrations with closed or non-transparent waitlists, limited communication, and uncertainty around how spaces are allocated, particularly within subsidized programs. These challenges are compounded by high costs and limited availability, often forcing families to rely on informal or unlicensed care arrangements.

Across responses, there is a clear recognition that childcare availability directly impacts workforce participation, economic stability, and quality of life, particularly in a high-cost, shift-based community like Revelstoke. While respondents expressed appreciation for efforts to assess and address these issues, there is a strong and consistent call for coordinated, transparent, and timely action to improve access, fairness, and system capacity.

SECTION 4.0

NEXT STEPS & POTENTIAL ACTIONS

Moving from findings to action.

Addressing childcare in Revelstoke requires both system-level change and coordinated local action. This section outlines a strategic framework and priority implementation areas to strengthen childcare as essential infrastructure, support workforce participation, and improve long-term community sustainability.

4.1 Next Steps and Potential Action Plan

Addressing childcare in Revelstoke requires both system-level change and coordinated action. The following framework outlines a strategic approach to strengthening childcare as essential infrastructure within the community.

Treat Childcare as Economic Infrastructure

The municipality, Provincial government, Federal government, employers, schools, and childcare providers must stop viewing childcare as a private family responsibility and recognize this as an economic pinch point.

- Including childcare in community growth plans / the City's Official Community Plan (OCP).
- Integrating childcare into community workforce development strategies.
- Requiring childcare considerations in major housing, new schools and other development projects.

Rapidly Expand Infant & Toddler Spaces (0-3)

Revelstoke needs to prioritize reducing childcare waitlists to under 6-months. Attaining this goal will support economic development through workforce support.

- Expand existing centers faster by reducing red tape from all levels of government.
- Adopt a community modular/flexible childcare facilities plan.
- Incentivize employer-supported childcare partnerships.
- Prioritize infant/toddler licensing grants.
- Use under-utilized public spaces temporarily.

Build a Sustainable ECE Workforce

A sustainable childcare system requires Early Childhood Educators.

- Advocate to the Province to support having ECE's under the public school system.
- Wage enhancement and parity strategies.
- Advocate to the municipality to find pathways to housing support for ECEs.
- Create partnerships with post-secondary establishments offer on-going local training pathways.
- Create a workforce strategy for Revelstoke.

Other Relevant Advocacy Priorities

Consistent advocacy for Childcare Priorities in Revelstoke is important to ensure sustained growth and consistency in communications to all levels of government.

- Request that the province create a centralized childcare system, that supports shortening waitlist times, reduces duplication, improves fairness and provides accurate demand data across BC.
- Request that the Federal government allow the expansion of ages and hours that childcare providers and establishments can operate. Supporting workforce needs that extend beyond 8am-5pm.
- Request that the City of Revelstoke increase funding for local childcare supports.

APPENDIX A

VOICES FROM THE COMMUNITY

Grounding the data in lived experience.

This appendix includes anonymized open-ended survey responses that provide deeper insight into the experiences, challenges, and priorities expressed by families in Revelstoke.

Responses have been anonymized and lightly edited for clarity while preserving original meaning.

9 What is your work/study situation? (OTHER)

- | *On maternity leave but will go back full-time if we can get child care*
- | *I work part-time, I study remotely, and I am a casual on-call EA*
- | *Normally work full-time 12-hour shift work*
- | *I need to be working but don't have child care*
- | *Full-time (or more) in winter, less than full-time in summer*
- | *I work two jobs*

10 Where do you do your paid work? (OTHER)

- | *All areas of Revelstoke—construction*
- | *All of Revelstoke*
- | *All over town*
- | *All over town*
- | *Contract work outside of the province*
- | *Cpkc railway*
- | *Downtown*
- | *Entire area of Revelstoke*
- | *Every elementary school in Revy*
- | *Heli-ski from town*
- | *Home office and out of town*
- | *Many areas. Travel throughout Revy*
- | *Multiple jobs, different areas*
- | *One more adult*
- | *Revelstoke Dam*
- | *Revelstoke dam*
- | *Salmon arm commuter to hospital*
- | *Shelter Bay*
- | *Travel to the Okanagan*

13 What is your spouse/partner's work/study situation? (OTHER)

- | *My spouse/partner is disabled and unable to work*
- | *N/A. I am the only parent*
- | *Railway – works all hours and is gone for 32 to 50 hours at a time*
- | *Seasonal winter and summer work*
- | *Seasonal. Summer works over 60 hrs a week.*
- | *Separated*
- | *Single mother*

14 Where does your spouse/partner do their paid work? (OTHER)

- | *Airport*
- | *Alberta*
- | *All of Revelstoke*
- | *All of Revelstoke and extended*
- | *All over*
- | *All over*
- | *All over Revelstoke*
- | *All over Revelstoke*
- | *All over town and outside of town (highways)*
- | *All over, construction*
- | *Backcountry lodge*
- | *Bush/Forest*
- | *Changes jobs too often to keep up*
- | *Construction all over town, home office*
- | *Rail*
- | *Rail*
- | *Rail*
- | *Different areas, in construction*
- | *Downtown*
- | *East gate of Glacier National Park*
- | *Ferry*

- | *Fly-in, fly-out, two weeks on, two weeks off in Northern BC*
- | *Does a variety of work across Revelstoke and the Interior of BC*
- | *Is a carpenter and works on various projects across town*
- | *Is a carpenter, so all over town*
- | *Works in the wildfire industry, based locally, but work takes them across the province*
- | *In the field*
- | *Lodge based near Golden*
- | *Lodge work*
- | *Mica Dam*
- | *Mica Dam*
- | *Mica Dam*
- | *Mill*
- | *Mountain guiding, travels to various backcountry locations*
- | *Is a ski touring guide and works remotely*
- | *Works remotely for ski guiding lodges in winter / and locally in summer*
- | *N/A*
- | *N/A. I am the only parent*
- | *N/A*
- | *Northern BC, two weeks on/off*
- | *O*
- | *Out of town*
- | *Out of town*
- | *Out of town*
- | *Rail*
- | *Rail*
- | *Rail*
- | *Remote contract working*
- | *Remote heli-ski lodge, forestry work*
- | *Revelstoke Dam*
- | *Revelstoke Dam*
- | *Single parent*
- | *Some out-of-town field work*

- | *Stay-at-home parent*
- | *Two jobs (one winter, one summer), one of which is shift work away from home*
- | *Various locations*
- | *Various locations (mostly Arrow Heights)*
- | *Work away*

20 What is the primary care arrangement for this child (i.e., the one you use the most, excluding school)? (OTHER)

- | *I have taken extended leave, but returning to work in a month. We will be getting a nanny (very expensive)*
- | *Licensed preschool with supported child development worker*
- | *Nanny, but lost them as it was unaffordable and couldn't find reliable care, and luckily got into daycare as one of us was going to quit*
- | *Grandparents*
- | *Nanny*
- | *Spouse/partner or I until child care is found*
- | *Currently on maternity leave*
- | *I am on maternity leave but have tried to get into daycare for the fall, but so far unsuccessful. The earlier questions about whether lack of daycare has impacted returning to work are hard to answer, but we are stressed as no care is lined up and I need to return to work financially for our family*
- | *Since September we have had child care, but it took us 3 years*
- | *After-school program*
- | *Myself for first 12–18 months, then caregiver in home if unable to find daycare*
- | *Myself – at home on maternity leave*

27 Why did you choose this arrangement? (OTHER)

- | *A spot opened up for my children after all other facilities were refusing my second-born child because of a health problem*
- | *All that is available - the situation is dire*
- | *At home or at school now*
- | *Child was too young to go to a group scenario*
- | *Connection to early years facilities and elementary school*
- | *Convenience and amazing child care provider*
- | *Could accommodate/offer support for a child with special needs*
- | *Family is free*

- | *Free, trusted family member*
- | *Had no other choice*
- | *Was a younger sibling of an older child who attended, and therefore was offered priority for care*
- | *High-quality group care – mixed ages, small group, and outdoor-based activities*
- | *I am on maternity leave currently, so the baby stays home*
- | *I am still on parental leave, so my child is at home*
- | *I care for my child myself*
- | *I have no child care help and am the primary caregiver*
- | *I look after this child as no daycare is available for children aged 1 in town*
- | *At home as no child care is available*
- | *It was the only option we could find*
- | *It's our only option with our work hours*
- | *Maternity leave*
- | *My child is with me full-time, but just got into _____ for September 2026. It will be 34 months total on the waitlist*
- | *My partner/spouse and I take care of this child*
- | *My partner/spouse or I have to because both of us work shifts and the hours do not align well*
- | *N/A, none found yet*
- | *Neither child was able to get into a care setting, so my partner/spouse is home with them*
- | *No other choice*
- | *No other options*
- | *No spot in a program and we could not afford a nanny*
- | *Older sibling attending*
- | *Older sibling is there too*
- | *On maternity leave and trying to get child into care for the fall, but facing long waitlists, very few daycares for 1-year-olds, and it seems impossible*
- | *Only available option right now*
- | *Only option*
- | *Only option as we do not have real child care; my partner/spouse has not yet returned to work*
- | *Only option available*
- | *Only option I had*
- | *Sibling got in first, then priority was given*
- | *Still on maternity leave*

The hours and style of care offered suited what I was looking for

The only option we have

The only way I could return to work

We hired a nanny

We use _____ when available but pay for two days a week to ensure access; the rest of the time we rely on grandparents or other parents in the community. It is affordable

28 How does this child typically get to and from childcare? (OTHER)

At home with me

Car in winter, bike in summer

Car, bike, walk

Parent walks child in the morning, and a parent picks up by vehicle at the end of the day

_____ is at school, or a grandparent collects from school using a car

Lives on-site; takes the bus from school

Support worker pickup and drop-off

31 How easy or difficult was it to find care for this child? If difficult, please explain briefly why.

1–3 years was impossible. We only got a spot because a close friend opened her own daycare.

After 12-month mat/pat leave, my husband had to negotiate with his work to take unpaid time off (2 additional months) so I could go back to work and keep my job. We ended up getting an au pair full-time/living in our house. Cost us about \$1,800/month. We got child care offered to us when our son was 26 months old. We are at _____ and love it! Our son will be starting school in Sept. We do not have after-school child care and are super stressed about it. I heard _____ is full.

After contacting all daycare providers in town, it took 8 months to find a part-time spot and 18 months to get a full-time spot.

Because every child care provider has a big wait list and I'm supposed to come back to work in May and I can't find anything, just wait lists.

Cannot rate child care as baby is in care with mom on maternity leave. Hope to be able to get her into child care this fall but have been told cannot get on some waitlists and then others are 50 to 150 on the waitlist, which is crazy. There is an even greater gap of childcare for 1-year-olds and when parents are trying to get back to work. Puts pressure to either quit their job (but cannot really do that financially), move, or find another care solution that may not be as suitable for our child. Would happily pay more taxes to have enough adequate child care facilities in this town, similar to paying taxes for kids to be able to go to school. Huge gap in care for children in this town and very expensive. Seems like you have to know someone to get into child care here and is quite discouraging. Lack of affordable childcare has greatly influenced (among other factors) some couples I know not having children.

Can't get in anywhere.

Child with autism, global developmental delay. Needs to attend with support. Before we knew we needed support, waited on lists for 2+ years.

Difficult in that our relative has to balance their part-time work schedule with ours.

Difficult to find a nanny or determine credentials/find a good fit.

Difficult to find a trusted person that would care for my son longer than a season. There are a lot of seasonal workers in town.

Finding a nanny to commit longer than 6 months has been difficult and is creating many transitions for kids.

Finding a nanny wasn't too difficult, but we will be doing a nanny share, both families paying \$17.50 per hour. As we are paying them as an employee, we have to add EI, CPP, and holiday pay, plus paid sick days. This is extremely costly but we have no other option. It's truly disheartening.

Finding the right days/times for my schedule has been difficult.

Got a spot very last minute after lacking childcare.

Had to go through a lot of interviews and criminal record checks.

Had to wait until he was 3. Before three, he was in a very expensive day home that did not qualify for CCFRI.

Hard to find a good nanny!

Have not found one yet. No availability.

Haven't found childcare. Have family watching on the days spouse and I work.

Haven't found care.

Our first daycare closed 3 weeks prior to me getting back to work. It was a family daycare. I've contacted multiple childcare providers and no one would even consider putting him on the waiting list because of his health issues. I was horrified by the situation....

I am still waiting on waitlists.

I got on many waitlists as soon as my kids were born and only heard back from one daycare. I felt like I had no choices. Just take what you can get.

I had to drop work because I couldn't find childcare after my 18-months maternity leave. I applied to all daycares, some were very transparent about the Waitlist, some others were not following any waitlists. Few daycares closed during that time, so we lost our potential spot and our promised ones. We finally got a place in September which didn't accommodate my work schedule, and we were lucky to find another spot when she turned 3 y/o that meets all of our needs.

I had to open my own child care centre in order to have care for our child.

I have had to give up work to be at home with my child, and while I value this special time, it has made financial needs a primary stressor for our family.

I have not found child care. I care for my child in my home. I am currently on some wait lists, other childcare locations do not have wait lists. Wait lists are not transparent. I have heard some places take families based on who they know or what their jobs are and not based on child age, where they are at on the list. I appreciate that the _____ has up to date info on childcare locations in town. It's tricky because each has their own intake and list process. Would be nice if there could be one master list for all of town

I opened my own childcare establishment.

I was new to Revelstoke, so I knew it was going to be a nightmare to find a spot. I was going to have to take an on-call job if I couldn't get care. Then the weekend before my job started, this spot came available and I got it. We are incredibly lucky because I think it was sincerely a right time and right place moment. I would have really struggled to get care otherwise and be able to financially support my family.

I was on a wait list for 2.5 years for my three-year-old and struggled during that time with unlicensed care and sporadic care.

I watch my child all day and go to work in the evenings due to not being able to find childcare.

I worked very hard to secure childcare for 18 months. And I hustled! Working full time, it was very hard to secure childcare and we resorted to a very expensive nanny situation. We are on many lists, but lack of transparency made it very challenging to plan.

It is incredibly difficult to find childcare. I am told I am behind 60+ families on most wait lists. It feels impossible.

It took 3 years to get my oldest into day care, and once he got in my second at age 18 months got in as well. I was on all the wait lists and contacting everyone multiple times a year. I don't believe it's first-come, first-served. It's more about who you know. I finally got lucky and got into a good place.

It was pretty difficult until our son was 2.5. We had a variety of arrangements—nanny, worked less, and switched between working and childcare.

It's less expensive to pay the flight ticket of my parents coming from abroad than hire a nanny.

It felt like we never got a call for spaces available. Had to reach out repeatedly to see if a space had opened up.

Lack of availability.

Lengthy waitlists with no real sense of when we would get a spot or where we were on the list; had to rely on friends and family for the first year of childcare after an 18-month mat leave.

Limited spaces and age out at 9.

Long waitlist; had to extend my maternity leave due to lack of child care.

Many licensed childcare facilities don't keep wait lists or return your calls or emails. A couple went out of business when I was on the hunt, including one I was planning to use. I ended up using an unlicensed provider for a brief time who was fulfilling a need for those of us in tough circumstances and unable to find childcare when needed. We got in where we are by chance, as it felt like someone ahead of me on the list declined their offered spot.

Massive waitlists.

My grandmother had to retire early to care for my son to have care.

No certainty for wait times. Child was part-time for the first year.

No licensed care available. No care centre responded to my initial emails. Private nannies are completely unaffordable for an only parent and difficult to find. I flew my mom in to help from Ontario, but I am able to do less work with her staying with me than alone because she became ill a few days after arrival, is high maintenance, and expects too much interaction and visiting time with me.

Not enough spaces anywhere!!

On every wait list until she was 3, following up every month. Had to pay for a very costly nanny and drop working hours.

Only choice was to hire in-home help for \$30/hr when neither parent is working; that is a massive drain on savings.

Only got a spot as a friend was able to vouch for our family.

Only have part-time childcare (10h/week) at a cost of \$20/hour.

Only option I had was my grandmother, my child's great-grandmother. We moved from a big city centre to be closer to family and we were unable to find child care, so my grandmother has been watching my son for two years and now she is getting too old to keep up. My son has been on waiting lists for almost two years.

Primary care is at home with me because no childcare options are available. On one waitlist. Other places won't even take our name.

Really hard to find childcare for under 2 years old, even after applying while pregnant.

Since he was born, we have asked for the child care list almost every month. We email or call, but sometimes they don't even answer the emails. If they do answer, they put you on the waiting list and that's it—no more communication. If you ask about fees, hours, snacks, or lunch, I can say that half of the places respond rudely, especially considering the amount of money people ask. In the end, you just have to wait until one that accepts him is not too expensive.

Still waiting for a spot for both our children.

There are just not enough spots for the amount of people who need childcare—especially infant/toddler spaces.

There doesn't seem to be any options other than paying a lot of money for a nanny. I am supposed to return to work in a month and we just don't have any options. My job is a full-time position and my husband works away during the week.

There is no availability in town. Most providers do not respond to queries or give any indication as to when space becomes available. It is not a first-come, first-served basis for facilities, creating frustration and inequity.

There is no child care. Parent provided only.

There is no childcare in this town. We resorted to cutting down my hours at work and then having a friend look after our daughter until we can find something more permanent.

They are 1, and there are very limited spots for that age in town; hence why they are staying at home with a parent.

Too few infant care spots.

Was lucky to get a spot a month or so before returning to work, and was considering not being able to return. Before getting a spot, I spent many hours contacting care facilities since birth (can't go on a list before birth—as a planner this stressed me out a lot during pregnancy). I was on all the waitlists but told I wouldn't likely get anything until my child was 3. Very stressful and almost had to resort to a care situation we were not comfortable with for legal/safety concerns. Ended up losing money on a deposit after withdrawing my child—took it as a loss, happy our child only went there twice.

We are on every waiting list possible for childcare. The current childcare we have is unstable, uneducational, and we are desperate for more options in Revelstoke. We specifically found it hard to find childcare for under 18 months.

We did not have childcare until he was almost 3.

We didn't have support until a couple years ago, when grandparents retired. Before that my work schedule had to revolve around care hours that we could get. My daughter was 2 and a half before I found consistent care and even then, it being a home childcare, there was constant closures due to her own children being sick. This left us often scrambling for support or calling in sick myself to work.

We had to hire a nanny because no spaces were available.

We had to send lots of emails to all daycares.

We have a nanny as we haven't received a spot in a childcare facility.

We lucked out completely.

We were given the wrong information to get on waitlists for the \$10 per day programs and had thought we were on them when our baby was born but were told a year later that she was never on it as they weren't accepting anyone on the waitlist when we got in touch. We never heard back from other programs other than _____ who has been amazing for drop in. For parental benefits we had to have dad quit work and stay home as mom is self employed and could not close the business but was not eligible for benefits. That was a new kind of hell to navigate freshly post partum especially with needing to pump and new family dynamics. I will say though, 3 years later we do not regret a single moment and have loved spending so much time raising our child.

We were just lucky we found a daycare spot when a friend re-opened their daycare. It is very difficult to find childcare in Revelstoke, and group family daycares should have access to the \$10/day funding benefits as it is still quite expensive.

We were never able to find care, and our child is almost old enough to not need it.

We were on a waitlist for this spot for 2 years. The only other lead we had wouldn't begin until our child would be 3.5 years old. From age 1–3, we hired nannies and did nanny-shares with other families.

We were proactive and put our son on all available waitlists immediately after he was born, knowing we would need care after our paternity leaves. We only received responses saying facilities were full or waitlists were not being taken. The _____ referred us with a comprehensive list of unavailable/full options - this service was unhelpful. Our only option was to desperately search (facebook, word of mouth, expensive websites) and find unaffordable privatized care in our home, allowing us to return to work. We are a double income family who can barely afford to keep 1 child in full-time care.

33 Does your child's current care arrangement meet the ability needs of your child? (OTHER)

Absolutely, but it's very expensive and can barely make it.

Can't get into any child care. Currently have a nanny that does, yes.

Doesn't have current care arrangements.

I care for my own child and am unable to work more because of this.

I guess, first-time parents, so we're guessing at what is required.

I hope.

I think so.

I would prefer to have the child in an after-school program; however, at 8, he is older than most kids in _____ and struggles with outdoor-based childcare in the winter.

No, they are ready for more social development amongst peers and learning from another adult (teacher), which we cannot do at home.

No, he needs more social interaction with children his age.

Not quite. I will need to return to work in November and cannot care for my child at that time.

Now, yes (he is 12 and can stay home alone for some time). Previously, it was very challenging.

Yes – infant stage = home on maternity leave and no care requirements needed until return to work.

Yes, although care hours were reduced while I was on maternity leave.

Yes, because she's at home with us.

Yes, but not desirable long term as he is with me and I need to return to work.

Yes, now that she's able to stay home alone. We paid over half a paycheck to afford childcare for 5 years. With our first child, we had to work opposite shifts for 5 years as we couldn't afford or find childcare.

Yes, attends preschool with SCDP worker. Attends unlicensed babysitting in provider's home with no support, but it has taken 3 years of transitions to settle in. Not enough hours, but child is making huge gains now.

Yes, but our work needs are compromised.

Yes, for now as I am on maternity leave. No idea what we will do this fall.

Yes, we are in the midst of developing a support plan there for her.

Yes. Currently on maternity leave; baby will start childcare in May.

Yes. I am not sure if it will get to it in the survey; my oldest was on waitlist for 2 years.

Yes. Our daycare exceeds expectations and has amazing staff and programming. We are willing to pay extra cost, even with the basic \$30 subsidy, because we prefer it to the larger \$10 programs in town.

35 Would you change this child's care arrangement(s) if a preferred option became available at a price you could afford? If yes, why?

\$30/hr is a lot.

Affordability.

Available daycare for 12 months old would solve our need.

Because he would have more access to supports, as well as the socialization he needs.

Because my family have a life abroad and they cannot be in Revelstoke all year long just to allow me to go to work.

Cost.

Could work more, not relying on family when they are busy too.

Current arrangement is Mon–Thursday but we both work Mon–Friday.

Currently I rely on my parents and my ex sister-in-law to do the childcare. It would be nice not to have to rely on my parents.

For question 25, I answered No to 23 but won't let me continue survey without answering 25. Do not use those answers.

Having stable schedules of Monday to Friday full-time childcare for working parents is greatly needed in town.

I am going on mat leave soon and we won't be able to afford a nanny once we drop to one salary.

I cannot care for my child when I return to work and hope for a place that aligns with my work hours.

I could definitely do with a more affordable option and also one with better care.

I don't actually have a care arrangement, I can't find one.

I feel it would be nice for him to get together with more kids and learn new things.

I need more care. I only have 12–17 hours per week covered by the affordable childcare benefit.

I think it's good for my daughter to play out of the house with her buddies and also I need to work to pay bills.

I would change it in the fall for when I go back to work. Right now no, as I am on maternity leave.

I would have the option to work more.

I would like to be able to work part time.

I would love to return full-time to my career and have my child in a centre that encourages creative learning, outdoor-based play, etc. to help them develop. I need to work in order to afford my mortgage.

I'd like to work part time but doesn't seem like it's an option for child care, it seems like everyone favours full-time positions.

I'd love to have one day per week to work all day.

If I didn't have to work, I'd prefer to be the one who collected her after school and spent time with her, but the community demands a full-time dual-income household.

Interested in daycare but we haven't been accepted anywhere yet.

It would be more affordable.

It would take the pressure off me to provide quality care alone. It would allow me to exercise or focus on school work.

It's hard taking care of our child with both of us available full time. A return to work without some assistance for just one of us will be hard—both of us, impossible. At the moment, the only assistance option we've found is a part-time nanny/babysitter. This is problematic because: 1. It's expensive. 2. It's unreliable—there's no backup plan if they're sick/on leave. 3. It's generally not a long-term option—most people doing nanny work are seasonal. 4. The standard of care is wildly variable, entirely based on the nanny's skill and experience.

Lower cost.

Miss less work time.

My partner and I could stop juggling schedules to care for our child full time.

My wife would like to work.

N/A.

Nanny is too expensive. Would prefer a spot at a day care.

No.

No, because I believe our care is exceptional at the current facility.

Our current situation is in someone's home. We would like to be in a safe, secured location that is dedicated to childcare.

Our current situation will not work long term.

_____ is the best care in Revelstoke.

Relative as childcare has created other family issues.

Small space, lack of day-to-day variety, last-minute closures.

So he can have a better social understanding and support care that he needs.

So I can work more.

So I could go back to work.

So I could work full days and not evenings and weekends.

Socializing with peers, more educational programs, consistent care.

Something more structured and affordable.

To have a steady and reliable option for years to come, and also for my second baby coming up. My nanny is awesome but I never know when she's going to retire from nannying.

To relieve my family member so they could provide less care.

To return to work full time.

We are making extreme changes to our careers to make sure our child's care and learning is paramount.

We are planning a part-time nanny to allow me (mother) to return to work part time. This is not financially practical in the short term, but will prevent me from losing my professional designation from being off too long.

We have a fantastic home day care situation, but as he gets older we would prefer a more structured, pre-K focused facility.

We have a friend looking after our child on the days we both work.

We have a spot within \$10/day.

We have just gotten into _____ for September 2026 after 34 months on the waitlist. We are going to take advantage of that opportunity to provide me with the capability to return to work.

We have not been able to find childcare other than a regular babysitter.

We pay \$22 an hour, 40 hours a week. It's crazy expensive and I'm only working because I want to keep my job long term, not because it makes financial sense.

We were never provided the luxury of choosing a daycare based on facility quality, care providers, time outside, or suitability for our family and child. I would much prefer to have my child socializing with a larger group of kids in a daycare facility. The high cost of privatized care is unsustainable for us, which necessitates the need to continue searching for more affordable options—often leading to high levels of stress due to uncertainty.

We will be doing a nanny share, both families paying \$17.50 per hour. As we are paying them as an employee, we have to add EI, CPP, and holiday pay, plus paid sick days. This is extremely costly but we have no other option. It's truly disheartening. In addition to the wear and tear on our home and mode of transport that they also expect. It hardly makes it worth it.

We would like a part-time childcare option at an affordable price.

We would like our child to attend a quality daycare when space opens.

We'd love to get him into daycare but we can't get a spot, so had to hire a nanny.

We're trying to make the move to Revelstoke long term and I'm working here and commuting on weekends because we can't find full-time child care for our toddler to make the move as a family.

Work full time to afford life in Revy.

Would give me flexibility to return to work.

Would love full-time consistent care. Cost limits hours.

Would prefer licensed day care.

Would prefer to stay home, but if not, would want someone with one or two others to watch. _____ seems too many kids.

37 What would help improve your current childcare situation? (OTHER)

- | *A French language option would be amazing!*
- | *Ability to take siblings—i.e., I could probably find a spot for my middle son when he turns 3 in August, but that still leaves me with my 1.5-year-old without care.*
- | *Actual facility for childcare.*
- | *Any availability for child care under the age of 18 months.*
- | *Any child care during the day.*
- | *Better, more fulfilling programs for school-aged children—programs that my child looks forward to attending.*
- | *Child care spaces.*
- | *Childcare option we could get into/that has spots available.*
- | *Facility outside of my home.*
- | *Forest-based play.*
- | *Happy with current situation.*
- | *I was able to get my child into _____, but have had to reduce my hours to between 9–3 while on maternity leave, and it was a struggle to get any care at all.*
- | *Increased programming for older children.*
- | *More infant/toddler spaces.*
- | *More space and programming, more stimulation.*
- | *More structured care.*
- | *N/A – very happy with our current and future child care situation.*
- | *Nothing.*
- | *Nothing at this time because we lucked out with a spot when our child turned 3, but the biggest issue prior was availability.*
- | *Priority for low-income-only parents. Priority for BC citizens & permanent residents (I am aware of a family that is not legally residents of Canada who occupied \$10/day spaces in Revelstoke, and I wish there was a policy to prevent that).*
- | *Space/setting that both kiddos could attend—oldest (age 34 months) is on the autism spectrum.*
- | *We lucked out after being on all waitlists for over three years. Should have more government-funded options available and should make it easier and more cost effective for licensed private providers to start.*

38 What would be your ideal childcare arrangement for this child?

- | 2–3 days a week, 8:00–4:00, \$10/day.
- | 3 days a week.
- | 3 days a week when he turns 18 months.
- | 4–5 days a week, 8–4.
- | 7:30–5:30, Mon–Fri.
- | 8:30 to 5:30, Monday to Friday.
- | A forest-based play program with part-time options. We have so many outdoor learning opportunities for older kids but not for younger generations.
- | A full-time child care spot.
- | A licensed day care with quality ECEs, extensive outdoor time, and a more structured setting.
- | A licensed daycare that could take my 3 kids so I could go back to work. Having a spouse who doesn't have a work schedule doesn't allow me to go back to work with no childcare availability in town.
- | A space open by 8 a.m. and closes at 4:30–5 p.m. so we can properly get an 8.5-hour work day in.
- | A spot at a licensed group or family childcare centre with \$10/day fees, which prioritizes the spaces for low income families that have been in the community for years prior. I would like to see a coop with a location open where parents can obtain the required training and take turns being the staff, so they we can earn wages while looking after our own child(ren) plus additional children, while paying nominal fees for care when we are working at our other paid work.
- | Activities-driven care that's age appropriate for after school and cost effective. If it had transportation from school to activity, it would be ideal.
- | Affordable child care and availability in childcare centres. We will be paying \$180 per day for our nanny as it is our only option. That seems absolutely absurd.
- | After-school care.
- | After-school care—currently has a waitlist. I work until 5:30, so extended after-school care is needed.
- | Afterschool care from age 9–10.
- | An indoor (or indoor optional) program for kids aged 8–12 with supports for ADHD.
- | Any available child care.
- | Anything with the child care subsidy.
- | As above—either licensed family or group care.
- | As above—home with breastfeeding mother who is off work.
- | Be able to drop him off at 7:30 a.m. and pick him up at 4:30 p.m., with meals provided, including weekdays and weekends.
- | Being able to afford life in Revelstoke on a single professional income so one parent could stay home.
- | Casual, affordable drop-in care.
- | Child care centre, full-time preschool.

Currently have it, but it wasn't always this way. One day a week with grandparents and three days a week in a great childcare that is affordable. Our childcare is closed Friday, which can be inconvenient, and drop-in can get pricey on a budget.

Currently, with a parent.

Day care starting at 10–12 months old, ideally in the Big Eddy, but anywhere in town would work.

Daycare 4 days a week.

Daycare that we could get a spot in before 3 years old.

Daycares.

Daytime and evening care options.

Either home with mom or full-time daycare.

Exactly like where we are (_____).

Forest school.

Full days for both my kids.

Full time (6 hours+/day) preschool-type care program for 3–4 year olds. I like the graduated style that _____ offers; however, I believe the hours should be extended and the option for full-time Monday to Friday care rather than part time would work for more families with parents working full time. Children would also benefit from getting used to this schedule prior to going to kindergarten, and it would offer more consistency for families with kids of various ages within the same household. Thanks for putting out this survey!

Full time (Monday–Friday) to accommodate work hours.

Full time at a child care centre.

Full time care by qualified provider outside our home.

Full time child care at an ELC.

Full time childcare, but not for the same price I'm going to work.

Full-time, inclusive licensed care with support for special needs. My kid prefers routines and likes highly structured class environment. I work on-call, single parent, no family in town. I work PT hours and do university full-time from home to fill in gaps. Late night/early morning/overnight/weekend options. My schedule is flexible and need childcare to be as well. My work hours didn't fit most childcare centres/families when applying for wait lists.

Getting into a group childcare setting that offers \$10/day care or under \$100 a day in general.

Group care available at lower cost, with options for extra drop-in over weekends and evenings, as both of us get called out for work.

Half-day care, 5 days per week, with appropriate programming to support my child's development.

I am a very lucky person who got into an affordable child care spot, but the hours are really limiting. My spouse works long hours, so I have to do drop-off and pick-up, which limits the type of work I can do.

I currently love where my son is. The cost is lower, but it's still not \$10 a day. Living in Revelstoke is so expensive and every dollar counts.

I would love to secure a spot for my child by the age of 12–18 months at a licensed group childcare facility that employs certified early childhood educators that are passionate about early childhood development, play-based learning, outdoor learning, etc., where the cost can be subsidized by the provincial government.

- | *I would take anything at this point. Any affordable help with childcare would be life changing.*
- | *Ideal would be not having to work, but then would prefer a nanny or just a few hours a day drop-in with a small amount of kids, or even just someone to play with him at Leapland and Strong Start.*
- | *Ideally I didn't have to work the hours I do and I could pick her up from school. Otherwise, quality, engaging, skill-building, well-supported after-school care.*
- | *Ideally we would have child care Monday to Friday from 8–4 in a group facility with children their age, centrally located for a low fee.*
- | *Ideally, my child could be a part of a program with children his age. He would have access to all his supports. Full-time Monday to Friday at \$25–30 a day.*
- | *It was hard for us to find childcare, but now I wouldn't move him. Our provider is amazing.*
- | *Just cheaper.*
- | *Just enroll my baby in child care, meanwhile I or my husband work.*
- | *Licensed day care.*
- | *Licensed childcare group, availability, Monday to Friday childcare.*
- | *Licensed family childcare.*
- | *Licensed family childcare.*
- | *Licensed group childcare centre—Monday to Friday.*
- | *Longer hours to accommodate work schedules.*
- | *Me winning the lottery so I can stay home with them :).*
- | *Monday to Friday mornings to afternoon so I can work full time and help my spouse for expenses.*
- | *Monday to Thursday full working days, 7:45–4 or 8–5.*
- | *Mon–Friday care, beginning at 8 a.m. or slightly earlier to 4/4:15 p.m. My work schedule is 8–4 p.m.*
- | *Mon–Thurs, 8:30–3:30 p.m.*
- | *More care options available Mon–Fri.*
- | *My ideal care arrangement would be to have both my children in daycare 4 days a week.*
- | *My kids are registered in after-school activities and childcare isn't able to drop them off or pick them up from swimming/soccer/skating/baseball, etc. I have to leave work to get them and take them to their activities.*
- | *N/A.*
- | *Once maternity leave ends, it would be ideal to have Monday to Friday, 8 to 4.*
- | *One day a week.*
- | *Part-time care for days they are in preschool, with earlier drop-off times so I can get to work on time.*
- | *Part-time child care with a licensed daycare provider.*
- | *Part-time days, 3–4 days a week.*
- | *Part-time licensed childcare location.*

Part-time registered preschool or group up to 4 mornings a week. Would love an element of forest school available. Would also love some kind of French club for toddlers, as we can't do that at home!

Part-time (~20 hours/week) childcare in a licensed group childcare facility.

Part-time care.

Publicly funded group daycare centre.

_____ is perfect; we need more of these options for under 3 years old.

Reliable, full-time care at a licensed group childcare centre for an affordable price.

Safe place.

Same location—but small group daycare program being allowed by the city to expand slightly to allow for a couple more children in the infant program and \$10/day benefits provided to these care programs as well.

Slightly longer hours so I can get an 8-hour workday in. Currently, I am only able to get a 7.5-hour workday in as the daycare is only open for 8 hours and I need to get to work and back.

Small group daycare, or somehow subsidized nanny-care that could be “run” out of our own home, allowing for fewer spaces required in larger daycare facilities.

Structured environment, actual daycare facility, centre run by professionals.

The best would be a part-time position (happy to share a full-time position with another family), 3 days/week.

This is our ideal arrangement.

Three days a week daycare and two with the nanny, but subsidized so it's more affordable.

Three days per week (Tuesday to Thursday) with a nanny until he is 2.5 years old, then in a daycare, for affordability and consistency.

We are both shift workers (12-hour or more days), and child care is hard to find.

We currently have ideal care, but plan to have a second and are concerned what that will look like, as it was extremely difficult for ages 1–3.

We do not require childcare anymore but will not have more children, as this would be a factor that prevents one of us from returning to full-time employment.

We need early morning childcare drop-off at 06:30–06:45 and pick-up at 16:15, 2–3 days a week. Rotating days, which makes it challenging to choose specific days in a week. That is why a full-time spot is needed due to rotating schedule (shift worker), 12-hour shifts.

We now need after-school care at _____. If we could get this, we would be in a much better situation. Most likely I'll have to adjust/reduce my full-time hours.

We would prefer a licensed child care facility where curriculum is age appropriate.

What I currently have at _____.

When he becomes 12 months, minimum 3 days a week for 8 hours, up to 5 days a week for 8 hours.

When I go back to work, have her in a child care facility that is Monday to Friday and \$10/day, so _____ or _____ childcare. Ideally, though, an option at my workplace for care for my child plus coworkers' children that we could pay into as a benefit through work.

39 What do you like most about your current childcare arrangements?

- | *Ability to spend time with my kids while they are young, but also going crazy caring for 3 kids 5 and under full time.*
- | *Access to outdoor play and wild spaces.*
- | *Affordable.*
- | *Affordable.*
- | *Affordable, no extended closures for vacation, not closed when educators are sick. Good program.*
- | *Amazing, loving care, prioritizing time outdoors.*
- | *At home, flexible, affordable.*
- | *Caring providers and cost.*
- | *Close to work, small group setting.*
- | *Convenient, they meet from school so I can continue working.*
- | *Currently have a nanny, which is great for our family but not maintainable long term due to cost. Can't get into a daycare currently, so currently have no choice if I am to work.*
- | *Family feel.*
- | *Great caregiver.*
- | *Great program, location, teachers, and cost.*
- | *Having their mom with them is awesome—we are raising our kiddos!!*
- | *High standard of care, flexible.*
- | *Home with family.*
- | *I (father) get to spend lots of time with my child. We also have a great babysitter who watches our child (along with her own of the same age) for 10 hours/week, which gets our child more social time.*
- | *I care for my own child, which I love, obviously, but it is not sustainable as I return to work.*
- | *I don't have anything permanent at this time.*
- | *I get a few more hours of sleep.*
- | *I get to spend a lot of time with my child (home with parent).*
- | *I have left full-time work in my career field and I'm working.*
- | *I know my child is loved and cared for when with my parents.*
- | *I value that I can be her primary caregiver and create an outdoor, adventure-based learning environment.*
- | *I'm currently off with our child as I'm on parental leave. I will go back to work and my husband will stay off with my child until they are 18 months. I appreciate that one of my child's parents will be there with them until they are 18 months. We are on all the lists for daycare for after 18 months but have no prospects of getting in at this point.*
- | *Inclusive, supportive, flexible enough for cancellations and rescheduling for illness, etc.; respects my child's/my parenting needs and wishes; lots of communication; structured preschool setting; babysitting helps include him in social activities and be around other family dynamics; child has made huge gains since starting childcare.*
- | *It's my spouse.*

Location.

Location is very close to our house; daycare provider spends lots of the day outside with the kids; built-in subsidy brought down our daycare bill hundreds of dollars per month.

My daughter was on a waitlist for 2 years, went through various day home options with limited availability for 3 years, then got into _____ when she was 4. It was the biggest struggle, and then got priority access to my youngest, which helped greatly.

My husband and I take care of him in the mornings, and I do in the afternoon.

N/A.

N/A, still pregnant.

N/A.

Nanny share with another family gives my son someone to play and learn with. They get lots of exposure to activities around town.

One-on-one, extremely attentive care.

Our child seems happy.

Price is right, good morals and learning opportunities, nearby.

Several educators, allowing, I believe, a more fun work environment that gets passed on as a more fun play environment for the kids.

She takes them out in the community—to the coffee shop, library, parks, Strong Start, gymnastics, art gallery, city bus. The daycare also offers a daycare dance class. It's also a small group with one teacher.

Stay with my child.

That I care for my child. I wish I could care for her past 1 year old and stay at home, but financially it doesn't work and I need to return to my job.

That I have childcare.

That my child loves going there. It's fun for him and I know he is safe and cared for there. It's cheap and always open.

That we have child care. The availability is there Monday–Friday, open during spring break and the majority of Christmas break.

That we have some coverage.

The caregivers do care. The hours work for us. Mostly, the fact that we have care at all.

The people that run it, the amount of time spent outside, the communication, the activities, and that lunch is provided.

The staff are amazing. The kids and families that attend are lovely and we've made some really great friends through it. The hours are good, and we're fortunate with it being affordable.

The staff are great and are educated.

The time I get to spend with my child.

They don't need daycare anymore.

Very adaptable, small. Gentle caregiver.

We are utilizing after-school activities primarily to keep child off of screens until we get home.

We haven't started the arrangement yet, but having a nanny will mean closer connection.

When not on maternity leave, we have an in-home caregiver. Matches our shift work random schedule—perfect for us. I don't have to pack daycare snacks/lunches or deal with illnesses as often. Only paying for hours needed (e.g., weekends covered by spouse).

40 What would you like to change about your current childcare arrangements?

Ability to take kids to activities or be more centrally located for me to quickly grab them and drop them off, and be affordable enough to make it worth me working.

Availability. Longer days.

Being able to have child care.

Cost.

Cost, more flexibility for weekends and evenings.

Cost.

Daycare fees are still a major household expense and, with the increased cost of living, it's all adding up.

Difficult to predict how long we may be without childcare after birth.

Full time (Mon–Friday).

Have her part-time in a group or preschool setting to develop social skills and prepare for kindy.

Have no plan currently when maternity leave will end. Family live overseas; it would be much easier if they were close by.

Have options.

Have the nanny help more with household tasks. Be more affordable when there is not another family to share with.

Having a day for myself to work.

I don't have options.

I would like shift workers in our community to have better childcare options without having to give up our careers or hire a full-time live-in nanny.

I would like to be less reliant on them for care. Currently, they both work as well and need time to themselves.

I would like to have some.

I would like to make the cost affordable and for my child to be socialized more regularly with other kids.

I would love an evening option for child care.

I would prefer to be in a more structured care with multiple children, as I feel my child would benefit from that.

I wouldn't change anything. Our schedules can be very complicated and have long days (sometimes we need a nanny for drop-off and pick-up), but I wouldn't want longer daycare hours.

I'd like to find full-time care so I can return to work.

- | *If drop-off was a bit earlier, I could work more full time.*
- | *Improve children's experience and increase availability.*
- | *Just a minimal or part-time babysitter.*
- | *Just the restrictive hours.*
- | *Less expensive.*
- | *Less holidays.*
- | *Would love if they provided meals.*
- | *Lower cost and more hours. We pay more for 10 hours of babysitting than full-time daycare would cost.*
- | *More availability.*
- | *More hours.*
- | *More options for more days. Right now it's sporadic.*
- | *More outings, more attentiveness to full diapers, for example.*
- | *More part-time or regular drop-in options—even half days—to allow younger children to return home for naps.*
- | *More structured, consistent care to provide our child with what they need at their developmental stage. Also cost. Cost is too high.*
- | *More support so that I can also work, ideally 3–4 days per week, while still being present for these special years for our child. I need to be somewhat of a wage-earner in this economy where a single income is very challenging to sustain a household.*
- | *Need after-school care.*
- | *Need more help. I'm burning out all my friends with favours to watch my child in a pinch.*
- | *Need more hours!!! Even 10 more. Lack of support workers/high turnover in Revelstoke means cancellations are a no-go for my kiddo to preschool. Babysitter has their own kids and frequently needs to cancel/reschedule for illness.*
- | *Need early morning drop-off. It would be nice to not have to stick to a 9–15 schedule when not working and instead have an 8:30/09:00–16:00 option.*
- | *Nothing.*
- | *Nothing.*
- | *Nothing.*
- | *Nothing.*
- | *Nothing, but for the future/current parents of Revelstoke children, I am filling out the survey.*
- | *Nothing—it's incredible, aside from the fact that space is limited. I would love to see all families have access to the quality of care that our facility offers.*
- | *Options for daycare as needed.*
- | *Secure, ECE, not changing locations.*
- | *Something permanent and funded.*

The availability of safe, affordable child care.

The hours.

We would like to be able to spend family time in the afternoon.

Would like at least flexible, affordable part-time care.

Would like to get a spot in a daycare so I can return to work full time, as we would be able to afford childcare at a daycare versus a nanny.

Would like to get child into a care program so my spouse and I could work full-time hours again.

43 Which best describes your childcare needs for your children not yet in kindergarten?(OTHER)

4 or 5 full days. May be able to have care for one of the days where she is not in daycare.

Also preschool 2 days a week for 3 hours.

Rotating shifts. Husband can do Fri–Sun care. Some weeks need 0 care; max would be 2 × 10-hour days and 1 × 4-hour morning.

Which best describes your child care needs for your children from kindergarten to 12 years old? (OTHER)

Infant. N/A.

Only needed for my day shifts that land mon-thur - about 6 dates/month (when not on maternity leave and back to work).

47 Which language(s) are most often spoken in your home? (OTHER)

German

Czech

Filipino

Japanese

48 a One – What are the top three things you’d like to see happen...

\$10/day spots given based on income needs/hours worked. Ex. Some parents work very part time and yet they get a full-time spot and a mom that wants to work full time doesn’t get a spot, or \$10 spot given to family earning very high income.

\$10/day across the board.

Availability.

Access/availability.

- | *Affordability.*
- | *Affordability.*
- | *Affordability.*
- | *All daycares able to access subsidies.*
- | *Availability.*
- | *Availability.*
- | *Availability.*
- | *Availability.*
- | *Availability & access to programs.*
- | *Availability for children 18 months–3 years.*
- | *Availability of spaces in daycares.*
- | *Availability/open spots.*
- | *Availability.*
- | *Cost.*
- | *Drop-in location downtown.*
- | *Drop-in/as-needed care.*
- | *Extended hours.*
- | *Fair waitlists; my almost 4-year-old son has been on a waitlist for 3 years.*
- | *Feel that I won't need to scramble to find care for my youngest when I need to return to work.*
- | *Have family time in the afternoon.*
- | *I wish every family can access childcare if they need to at an affordable price.*
- | *Increase availability of licensed, affordable care.*
- | *Increase in facilities available that take 1–3 year olds.*
- | *Increase number of spaces.*
- | *Increase number of spots for young children under 30 months.*
- | *Increased availability.*
- | *Increased availability.*
- | *Infant care.*
- | *Make licensed care available to more families.*
- | *More affordable after-school programs.*
- | *More affordable options.*
- | *More affordable options that are licensed.*

- | *More availability.*
- | *More availability.*
- | *More availability.*
- | *More availability.*
- | *More available spots.*
- | *More child care spaces.*
- | *More childcare.*
- | *More childcare spaces.*
- | *More daycare places.*
- | *More daycares with good hours.*
- | *More facilities.*
- | *More full-time spaces available.*
- | *More licensed availability.*
- | *More licensed childcare.*
- | *More licensed daycares.*
- | *More licensed options.*
- | *More locations opened.*
- | *More options.*
- | *More options for families.*
- | *More options for younger children.*
- | *More physical spaces around town.*
- | *More space for 1–3 years old.*
- | *More spaces.*
- | *More spaces.*
- | *More spaces.*
- | *More spaces available.*
- | *More spaces available.*
- | *More spaces for children under 3.*
- | *More spaces/facilities.*
- | *More workers, including for support/special needs, recruitment and retention incentives.*
- | *New location.*

- | *Predictability and insight into waitlist position.*
- | *Programming for after-school that is safe and reliable.*
- | *Provide more childcare to more families.*
- | *Shift work schedule for working professionals.*
- | *Staff of childcare not telling me there is nothing they could do to help when looking for childcare.*

48b What are the top three things you'd like to see happen...

- | *7-day-a-week options.*
- | *Access to outdoor spaces.*
- | *Affordability.*
- | *Affordability.*
- | *Affordability.*
- | *Affordability.*
- | *Affordable.*
- | *Affordable.*
- | *Affordable – \$10/day ideally.*
- | *Affordable care.*
- | *Available/affordable locations for potential operators.*
- | *Be able to have time as a couple.*
- | *Better communication for when to expect a position to open up.*
- | *Better price.*
- | *Centralized waitlist.*
- | *Cheaper.*
- | *Cost.*
- | *Costs brought down for all families.*
- | *Decrease cost.*
- | *Easier access.*
- | *Ensure that any provincially or city-funded facilities prioritize those most in need—single parents, low income, special needs—not just those they know will best advocate for them, as it currently seems!*
- | *Extended childcare hours.*
- | *Flexible care – including irregular hours.*

Funded programs.

Higher standards for caregivers (e.g., education).

Hours.

If a mom is home on maternity leave, I think a \$10/day spot should be given to a working mom UNTIL first mom is back to work. It would still be the original family's spot, but if they are on maternity leave it could be used by another family in the meantime. Please note these two ideas are for the community in general—they have no impact on my childcare needs or personal experiences.

Leadership: _____ doesn't care about improving.

Longer hours.

Low-cost childcare.

Lower cost.

Lower costs.

Make childcare affordable (i.e., not \$40,000 to 50,000/year). Affordable does not need to be \$10/day—even \$75/day would be a huge improvement.

More affordable.

More affordable (more \$10/day).

More affordable childcare options.

More affordable prices, even partial funding.

More availability.

More care providers.

More child care spaces.

More daycare options for under 2.

More educational style, like Montessori.

More forest-based programs that utilize outdoor spaces and integrate outdoor play (>4 hours per day).

More funding for affordable childcare.

More kid-friendly spaces.

More licensed, affordable spaces.

More locations for all ages of kids.

More options.

More options for all breaks, not just summer.

More options for childcare and opening times.

More part-time options.

More part-time/drop-in spots.

More spots available for children.

- | *Nanny-finding services. Linking nannies with families.*
- | *New childcare spaces.*
- | *Not have to double dip with preschool and daycare. Full-time preschool would be a lot more convenient.*
- | *Part-time care.*
- | *Part-time spots.*
- | *Programming for stats/winter/spring break.*
- | *Programs to assist ECE licensing.*
- | *Proper staffing.*
- | *Quality.*
- | *Reduce the daily fee for childcare for young children.*
- | *Reduced cost.*
- | *Spaces.*
- | *Subsidized cost for all families.*
- | *Transparency of waitlist.*
- | *We need more affordable summer options for school-age kids.*

48 c Three – What are the top three things you'd like to see happen...

- | *\$10/day daycare facilities.*
- | *A parent work zone and kid play area for school breaks.*
- | *Access to quality childcare for children with disabilities.*
- | *Affordable.*
- | *Affordable full-time cover (9–5).*
- | *Affordable options for school breaks.*
- | *Camps that are inclusive of diverse needs (autism, etc.).*
- | *Continuity of waitlist and entrance decisions.*
- | *Cost.*
- | *Cost.*
- | *Cost.*
- | *Cost – feasible to work and still make some money.*
- | *Decreased costs.*

- | *Easier online drop-in booking.*
- | *Easier to get a spot (dreaming here!!).*
- | *ELC.*
- | *Extended hours before school and daycare as well.*
- | *Fair prices based on income.*
- | *Flexibility of care hours.*
- | *French daycare.*
- | *Have more daycare prices reflect the amount family is making.*
- | *Hours of operation.*
- | *Housing to bring in childcare staff to the community.*
- | *Ideally, a subsidized in-home care option for high-needs families.*
- | *Improved communication, support, and equity in selecting children for care.*
- | *Increase education and pay for ECEs.*
- | *Increased full-time spots.*
- | *Knowing where you are on a waitlist.*
- | *Licensed care.*
- | *Location.*
- | *Make waitlists fair and equitable (put more simply: HAVE A WAITLIST). Finding care should not be a popularity contest and based on who you know or your child's gender.*
- | *More centre/staff.*
- | *More child care spaces.*
- | *More childcare providers.*
- | *More drop-in.*
- | *More facilities that are full-time Monday to Friday.*
- | *More flexible options for non-full-time care.*
- | *More group facilities not in homes, with multiple educators present.*
- | *More inclusive programs that accept special needs kids and provide extra training to workers.*
- | *More licensed daycares.*
- | *More support in obtaining a license for potential operators from the City/community.*
- | *More transparency from childcare providers on how waitlists work.*
- | *Municipality to take some responsibility for being a family town.*
- | *Nature-specific.*
- | *No preferential treatment for certain people to get into daycares.*

Options near downtown would be amazing.

Outdoor programs.

Qualified carers.

Safety.

Shift work is just so hard to create an all-encompassing solution for. I have no realistic solution for this.

Space for children under 3.

Waitlist fairness.

Well-paid/educated staff.

49 How has your household been financially impacted by childcare availability in Revelstoke?

Because we couldn't find care until my child was 3, my position couldn't be held any longer at work. We had to live on one income until we had care.

Before we were fortunate enough to have a licensed space, we were paying \$65 a day, 5 times a week, for care. This was unsustainable.

Brutally during the preschool years.

By not being able to return to work full-time, I am taking a \$35,000 pay cut. In addition, because we don't have a spot in a licensed childcare facility, we are paying a babysitter \$20/hour for about 10 hours per week. This works out to about \$10,000/year.

A spot for our child in a full-time, \$10/day care would allow me to work full-time and cost significantly less than our current care. The result would be ~\$40,000 more in our pockets, which would in turn be spent mainly at local businesses. I'm sure there are others in similar positions to us who are seeing the lack of available childcare result in significant financial impacts. This reduction in income and spending power is likely to have a noticeable impact on businesses in Revelstoke if the situation is not improved.

Can't return to full-time work.

Currently can't get into any daycares, so have had to hire a nanny. Due to the high cost, I can only return to work part time instead of full time, as it's hardly worth working but I need to keep my job.

Either my spouse or I will not be able to work full time if we can't find childcare before maternity benefits run out.

For our first, we hired a nanny who would come to our home during the day until we got a spot in a licensed daycare. For the price of the nanny, it was financially not worth going back to work. With the second, I had a loss of income while waiting for a spot to open.

Fortunately our children are now past the age of needing care- we struggled for years trying to afford care as well as the cost of living here on top, and working opposite shifts for years when there wasn't available care that met the hours we needed it.

Had to get a live-in au pair for the first 2 years of living here.

Hard to decide if it's worth me going to work just to pay for child care.

Have had to have one parent stop working temporarily.

Have to stay home.

Having to get a nanny. This is going to cost us roughly \$720 a week, plus we have to pay for all stat days (not worked) and give 5 days paid sick leave. Plus, we have to pay a holding fee of 30% when we take a vacation. So we have to provide the location and mode of transport, cover the wear and tear, and provide food and snacks. It feels like we are being taken advantage of due to the lack of options and availability in town. It feels extremely unfair.

I am only able to work part time during school hours and evenings and weekends. This is exhausting. I have no downtime from life's responsibilities. I did not have full-time care prior to my kids starting school and could not return to work full time.

I had to go back to work only part time, so my income was cut in half.

I had to stop working completely and sit at home for 3 months while community connections found a support worker for my kiddo. Then he could only go very part time. I paid \$20 per hour to work 12-hour shifts, plus pickup and drop-off time and tip (~\$300), when I was making \$20/hour. I gave up a permanent position and now I am casual. I cannot apply for most jobs, as I frequently cannot come in to work due to last-minute childcare cancellations and cannot commit to most work schedules—even part time. My income has been as little as \$18,000 and as much as \$37,000. Not enough for a parent and child in Revelstoke!

I have had to take time off without pay. My child has had to come to my workplace after school. School breaks can cost up to \$900/month.

I mean its a good chunk of my income. My husband is the only reason we can afford to live in Revelstoke. I also could work longer hours if the daycare opened at 8 a.m.

If we do not find care, one of us may not be able to return to work or have to try find another more flexible job and reduce hours and pay.

Inability to go back to work full time.

Juggling jobs to make sure one parent is available as caregiver and work opposing schedules. Financially challenging to justify paying for childcare that is equivalent to wages earned working.

My husband and I have opted for the extended parental leave option. One 18 months pass, my husband may need to stay home from work as childcare spots are very difficult to secure for you children. This would significantly impact our family financially.

N/a

Negativity

Now living on only one source of income in the most outrageously overpriced town.

Partner cannot work, or if they do almost the entire salary goes to child care.

Poorly impacted! Multiple nanny's required and unlicensed high cost daycare fees.

Private fees, and babysitting is challenging and costs add up quickly (our financial situation has not always been this positive). Having to take a week off during very busy work periods is disruptive to the business I'm responsible for.

Quit my job, then returned part time 6 months later. Paid for a nanny to return to work.

Significantly. I have been unable to work since becoming a mother and taking on primary care duties. I have crammed my consulting hours into naps and after bedtime, and often have to manage my child while doing daytime calls with clients. I work in _____ and harassment and discrimination, workplace safety issues. It's been very tricky and I'm overworked and quite fatigued after three years of this. I know that I am privileged to be able to do it—to have the

education and have built a career that I can still be somewhat flexible with (I am self-employed)—and it's exhausting being an entrepreneur and a mother.

So far just trying to juggle one of us working full time while the other is full-time caregiver.

Somewhat negatively.

This has been a considerable source of stress for our household, but we have been lucky to find a spot. Neither my partner nor I have had to reduce our hours or leave employment, but we came close!

Unable to have dual income.

Unable to return to work full time.

Very hard to find after-school care; this impacts my wife's ability to work.

We are at _____ now, so it's better. Previously it was very expensive, and the hours made it difficult to work out of town, so I wasn't able to work for a while.

We are facing one of us not being able to return to work, significantly reducing our income and financial security.

We are lucky enough to get some subsidies and are in a program with government grants.

We are very impacted, as I only work once my husband comes home from work.

We got lucky to be received in one of the _____ facilities (\$10/day).

We had a live-in nanny prior to my decision to take time off work to care for our child. So childcare was either very expensive or I am making significantly less money working part time in another position without pension/benefits now.

We had to pay a lot for a nanny prior to getting a daycare spot.

We have had to resort to a nanny many times, and this is too expensive for us.

We were lucky to get a spot into one of the 10\$ a day center. Although this survey reflects more my 2nd child. It was easier to get a spot for her then my first one, who had to do 3 different daycare before she was 3 y.o. It was a very stressful time where the 1st daycare was closing and couldn't meet our child's needs anymore. We were at a point where we thought I would have to give up my job sine we couldn't find childcare or nanny for our specific work situation. Our 1st child had a lot of different caregivers in the first 3 years of her life between daycare, random babysitters. Luckily the 2nd time was easier due to prioritizing siblings. Our 1st child was on list for over 2 years before we got a place offered.

We've had high fees, subsidies, and varying childcare costs. It's been a huge financial impact on our family.

We've been lucky to get a lot of our childcare covered by subsidies.

When coming back from maternity leave, there was no childcare available. I could not return to my regular job and instead took a lower-paid job in a daycare to access childcare for my children.

When my children were in daycare, the cost was half of my paycheque. Summer camps were 85%, but I needed to use these resources to keep my job.

With our eldest, I couldn't accept full-time work due to lack of childcare for 3 years.

Working more than usual because it's so expensive in this town and childcare is so expensive.

Yes—we know it's short-lived and I make more than daycare costs, so it's still worth it. But with high cost of living (mortgage, groceries), it would help if daycare was more funded.

Yes. I have been underemployed for about a decade.

50 Do you have any other comments or suggestions you'd like to share to help with Childcare Assessment and Action Plans for Revelstoke?

Unfortunately not, but I appreciate the work that's being done on the matter!

Allow children to go on waitlists before they're born.

Change to the Revelstoke regime needs to happen. Money needs to be put back into community programs and staff, not just management wages for those hindering families getting help.

Cost of living in a resort municipality needs to be taken into account when childcare needs and costs are considered at all levels of government. We are in a unique situation here and require unique supports for families to thrive.

Figure out a fair and transparent way to manage a waitlist.

Government subsidy with daycare.

I have employees being significantly impacted by the affordable childcare options in Revelstoke. They can't afford the licensed private care and there are no spots available in the \$10 a day facilities. One person had to go on leave due to this shortage which will significantly impact their financial situation at home.

I have two school aged children. By the time I have paid for summer camps for them both, it is not worth me working financially, but I need to do this to keep my job. I would love for there to be more affordable care for all of the breaks. Those of us without family in town struggle to cover spring break and the Christmas break as well as summer.

I just think it shouldn't be so difficult to get your child into daycare. It should be readily available and affordable.

If it is a \$10/day program, the actual waitlist should be used; otherwise, people should be informed about who gets priority and why.

IH processes and regulations need to change. They look for reasons to say no when they need to be supporting new spaces. _____ gets extensive government subsidies and needs to step up to meet the needs of this community or pass the torch to someone who will take on this challenge. They are unsupportive of parents seeking care.

I'm super glad there is some movement in this area, with at least analyzing the need. As someone who runs a business, I can also see the large-scale effects on my own staff with having to change how they work due to limited options in town. Previously, I would work downtown and have to either race to childcare pick-up in Arrow Heights or Columbia Park, and it's usually by 5 p.m., or there would be late charges, and that isn't exactly conducive to a typical work schedule. It was a VERY stressful several years.

Our son also sat on a waitlist for over 18 months when he was preschool age. It was so challenging that my husband worked overnights, and we brought his sibling over from another province to watch our son during the day (while she was on mat leave too) so I could work as well. This went on for 5 months until we got part-time care, and then we just made the gaps work.

I brought my son to work with me for years, for several hours at a time, to complete my own work. I feel like this is still really common. Through our experience, we were also paying up to \$1,200 per month for care, making it barely worthwhile to work at all, but careers hinge on that. Not easy—very stressful and detrimental to mental health. I hope some practical solutions come out of this. Great work, folks!

In our experience, and anecdotally through friends and acquaintances, there seems to be a lot of discrepancy and confusion around how children are accepted into childcare establishments. It seems that certain people are given precedence over others, and in government-funded daycares that should not be the case; it should be regulated and

transparent.

Additionally, it seems that some of the families with higher-than-median income have their children in subsidized childcare when they can certainly afford other options. Again, I don't understand the method of choosing which children are accepted into subsidized care, but I would hope that income is assessed and lower-income families are prioritized. In a perfect world, it would all be "affordable." Also, I wanted to clarify that childcare felt impossible with our first daughter, who was 18 months old at the time we needed care. She was on every list possible, and in the end, when I had to either go back to work or give up my position, we ended up finding a nanny share with a family. It literally took almost my entire take-home pay, but the quality of care was phenomenal.

Is there an option to have more spaces in Okanagan College or other school district facilities or properties that are underutilized? Is there an option to have a city daycare facility? I would gladly have my taxes go toward daycare and youth programs over the proposed multiplex. The survey was a bit hard to answer correctly while on maternity leave, so I was not able to answer on quality of care in town. It feels like many parents have to rely on unlicensed care for their 1–3-year-olds or spend a fortune to be able to keep their jobs and stay in this town.

It's challenging knowing waitlists are closed due to excessive demand. Our new family would feel much more secure knowing our position on a community-wide waitlist was secured.

Make child care available again!

Need more daycare spots for children 1 and up.

One time I contacted _____, I waited two weeks to get an AI generated explanation, without heart or compassion about a deeply troubled email. It just was so off as a response. I attempted again, I inquired about a board position and was met with, "well what skills do you have?" From _____. It's clear they don't want parents opinions or help running or improving the show. This survey is unbelievably condensed with data and awesome! We are thrilled someone else is taking the lead, goodbye _____-thanks for nothing.

Please make childcare part of the birth-to-Grade-12 system. ECEs should be trained and paid similar to teachers.

School breaks and lack of extended after-school care can cost up to \$1,000/month.

So much greed in the community. Expensive housing, no change in community support or resources. Childcare and grocery store should become a priority.

So much of our industry here (railway/mill) and important careers (doctors, nurses, paramedics, fire, police etc) are shift workers. Unless one hires a fully time nanny (\$\$\$) it is extremely difficult to have both parents work shift work and find care for kids.

Summer childcare will be an issue in the future due to cost, availability, and limited hours of camps.

Thank you for doing this!

Thank you for working on a long term sustainable action plan for childcare, it is so important and much needed in our community.

Thank you so much for all your work on this.

Thanks for doing this! Looking forward to the results.

Thanks for doing this. Revelstoke really needs more childcare options.

There are families across Revelstoke utterly struggling to find suitable, reliable care for their children. Every month parents are being forced to leave the workforce, fall into debt and experience significant emotional stress. This is a crisis that is affecting the livability of our community. Please be as proactive and diligent as possible to find real solutions in a timely manner.

There should be an app where all childcare providers are registered, including their hours, rates, meals, and services offered. Parents could create a profile for their child, specify their needs, and the app would match them with the best available options. It would also manage waitlists and provide more accurate updates on when a spot might become available.

We understand that childcare is not a great business for private companies due to limited (or lack of) profits. I like to see the city step up to make childcare more available by offering space (buildings or land) to be used for childcare.

We could open more childcare spaces but cannot find qualified providers.

Whatever the waitlist system is, fairness for who is waiting is essential.

Y'all are amazing—thank you for doing this!!

Yes, I do not agree with people operating unlicensed. It is very sad that families are pressured into unlicensed care in order to keep their jobs, where they are unsure of the care their child is receiving whilst paying extortionate rates.